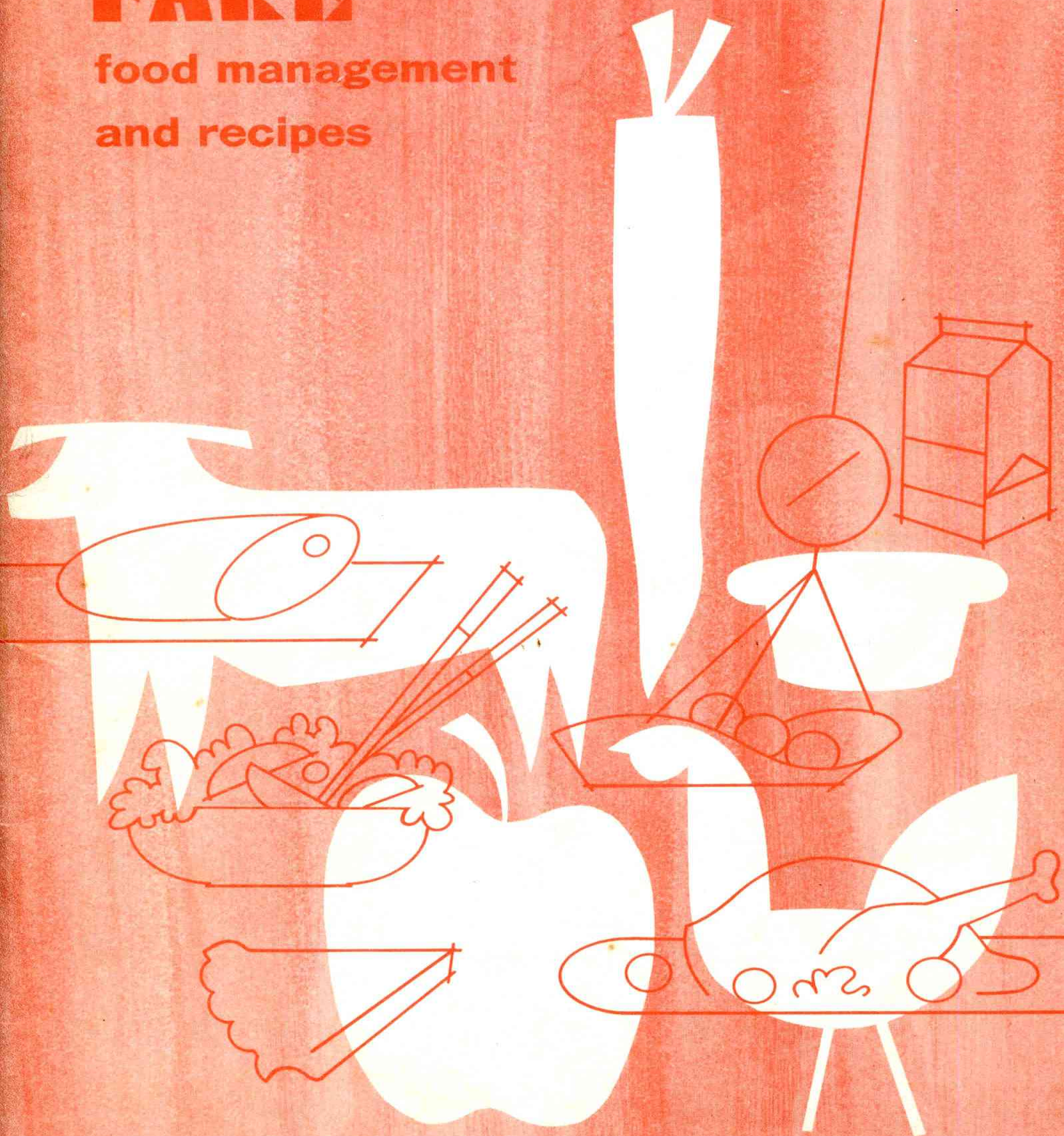


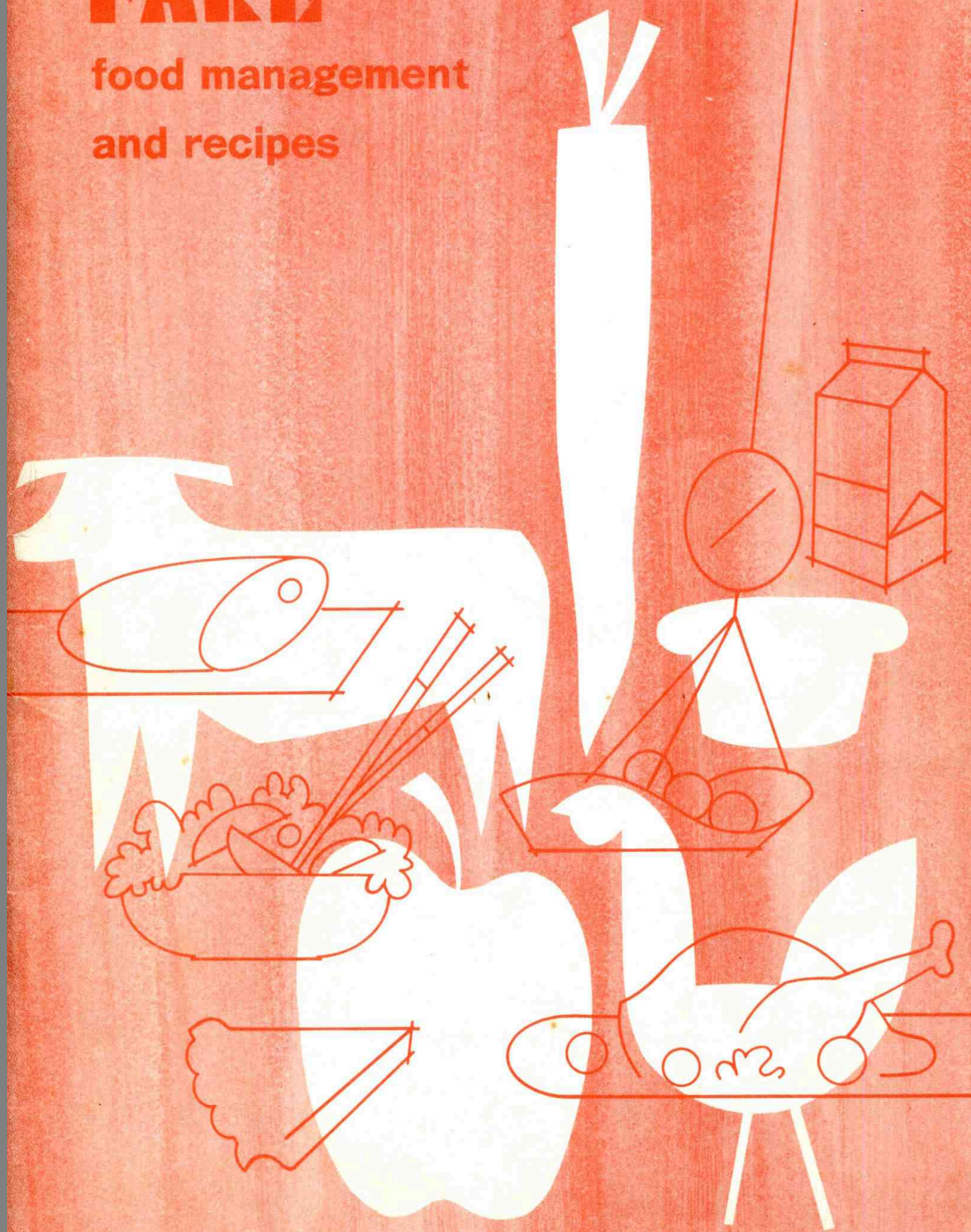
FAMILY FARE

food management
and recipes



FAMILY FARE

food management
and recipes



U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE • HOME AND GARDEN BULLETIN NO. 1

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FAMILY FARE

food management and recipes

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE · HOME AND GARDEN BULLETIN NO. 1

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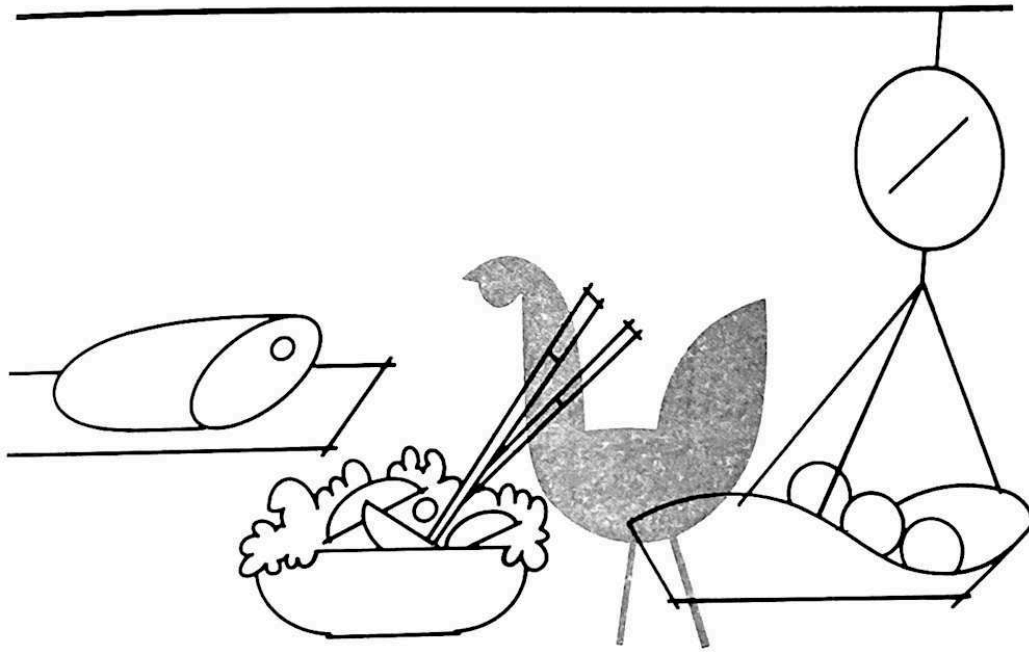
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FAMILY FARE

food management and recipes



Whether you are just learning the skills of food management and good cooking or are an experienced hand in the kitchen, this booklet—prepared by USDA food and nutrition scientists—can serve you well.

It combines good eating and good nutrition. It packs the results of years of food and nutrition research into a ready handbook for everyday use. It tells how to get the nutrients you need from a variety of foods—then translates this knowledge into taste-tested recipes and well-balanced meals.

Feeding your family well takes less time and work than it used to. Today's foods can have built-in convenience. Meals can be more varied because more food choices are available.

In this publication you'll find—

- A daily food guide—a simple, workable presentation of the kinds and amounts of foods to have each day.
- Tips on meal planning.
- Helpful information on buying, storing, measuring, and using foods.
- A selection of recipes—main dishes, vegetables, salads, soups, sauces, breads, sandwiches, desserts—plus variations of some of these recipes.
- Menu suggestions.
- A list of cooking terms.

NUTRITION....

Food At Work For You

Nutrition is the food you eat and how the body uses it.

People differ in how much they want to know about nutrition, but everyone needs to know a few facts about food and health as a basis for selecting the foods to eat.

You need food to get energy for work and play, to move, to breathe, to keep the heart beating—just to be alive. Children and youths need energy from food for growth.

Food also provides a variety of substances—nutrients—that are essential for the building, the upkeep, and the repair of body tissues, and for the efficient functioning of the body.

Everyone needs the same nutrients throughout life but in different amounts. Proportionately greater amounts are required for the growth of a body than just for its upkeep. Boys and men need more energy and nutrients than girls and women. Large people need more than small people. Active people require more food energy than inactive ones. People recovering from illness need more than healthy people.

You and your family can get all the nutrients you need from foods, but no one food contains all the nutrients in the amounts required for growth and health. Only a variety of different kinds of foods will supply all you need.

A guide to eat by

Nutrition scientists have translated knowledge of the nutrient needs of people and the nutritive values of foods into an easy-to-use guide for food selection.

This Daily Food Guide, on pages 4 and 5, sorts foods into four groups on the basis of their similarity in nutrient content. Each of the broad food groups has a special contribution to make toward an adequate diet.

Here are some of the reasons different food groups are emphasized in the guide and the names of some of the nutrients these foods provide.

Meat, poultry, fish, and eggs from the *meat group* and their alternates—dry beans, dry peas, and nuts—are valued for their protein. This is needed for the growth and repair of body tissues—muscle, organs, blood, skin, and hair. These foods also contribute iron and the B-vitamins—thiamine, riboflavin, and niacin.

Vegetables and fruits from the *vegetable-fruit group* are valuable sources of vitamins and minerals. In the guide, this group is counted on to supply most of the vitamin C and a large share of the vitamin A value in the diet. Choices are directed toward the citrus fruits and some other foods that are among the better sources of vitamin C; and toward the dark-green and deep-yellow ones for vitamin A value.

Vitamin C is needed for healthy gums and body tissues. Vitamin A is important for growth, normal vision, and a healthy condition of the skin and other body surfaces.

Foods from the *milk group* are relied on to meet most of the calcium needs for the day. Milk is the leading source of the mineral calcium, which is needed for bones and teeth.

Milk also provides protein, riboflavin, vitamin A, and many other nutrients. Cheese and ice cream also supply these nutrients, but in different proportions.

The *bread-cereal group*, with its whole-grain and enriched bread and other cereal products, furnishes important amounts of protein, iron, several of the B-vitamins, and food energy.

Fats, oils, sugars, and sweets are not emphasized in the guide because they are common in every diet. Some of the fats and oils provide certain of the vitamins, and some furnish essential fatty acids, but the chief nutritional contribution of these foods is energy value.

How to use the guide

Homemakers who follow the guide will find it flexible enough to use in choosing foods for families.

Food choices within the groups are wide enough to allow for a variety of everyday foods. Meals can be planned to include family favorites, foods in season, and foods to fit the family budget.

The size of servings can be suited to the needs of family members—small servings for children and for those wanting to lose weight; extra large servings (or seconds) for very active adults, teenagers, and those wanting to gain weight. Pregnant and nursing women also need more food.

Foods from the Daily Food Guide fit easily into a three-meals-a-day pattern of eating. Foods from each group often appear in each meal—but this isn't essential. The important thing is that the suggested number of servings from each food group be included sometime during the day.

Many people want and need more food than the minimum servings suggested from the four food groups. To round out meals and satisfy appetites, you can include additional foods from the four groups as well as other foods not listed in these groups.

A Daily Food Guide

MEAT GROUP

***Foods Included***

Beef; veal; lamb; pork; variety meats, such as liver, heart, kidney.

Poultry and eggs.

Fish and shellfish.

As alternates—dry beans, dry peas, lentils, nuts, peanuts, peanut butter.

Amounts Recommended

Choose 2 or more servings every day.

Count as a serving: 2 to 3 ounces of lean cooked meat, poultry, or fish—all without bone; 2 eggs; 1 cup cooked dry beans, dry peas, or lentils; 4 tablespoons peanut butter.

VEGETABLE-FRUIT GROUP***Foods Included***

All vegetables and fruits. This guide emphasizes those that are valuable as sources of vitamin C and vitamin A.

Sources of Vitamin C

Good sources.—Grapefruit or grapefruit juice; orange or orange juice; cantaloup; guava; mango; papaya; raw strawberries; broccoli; brussels sprouts; green pepper; sweet red pepper.

Fair sources.—Honeydew melon; lemon; tangerine or tangerine juice; watermelon; asparagus tips; raw cabbage; collards; garden cress; kale; kohlrabi; mustard greens; potatoes and sweetpotatoes cooked in the jacket; spinach; tomatoes or tomato juice; turnip greens.

Sources of Vitamin A

Dark-green and deep-yellow vegetables and a few fruits, namely: Apricots, broccoli, cantaloup, carrots, chard, collards, cress, kale, mango, persimmon, pumpkin, spinach, sweetpotatoes, turnip greens and other dark-green leaves, winter squash.



Amounts Recommended

Choose 4 or more servings every day, including:

1 serving of a good source of vitamin C or 2 servings of a fair source.

1 serving, at least every other day, of a good source of vitamin A. If the food chosen for vitamin C is also a good source of vitamin A, the additional serving of a vitamin A food may be omitted.

The remaining 1 to 3 or more servings may be of any vegetable or fruit, including those that are valuable for vitamin C and for vitamin A.

Count as 1 serving: $\frac{1}{2}$ cup of vegetable or fruit; or a portion as ordinarily served, such as 1 medium apple, banana, orange, or potato, half a medium grapefruit or cantaloup, or the juice of 1 lemon.

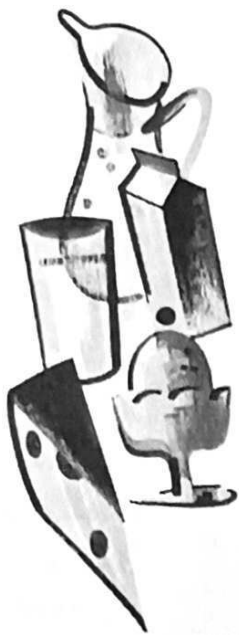
MILK GROUP

Foods Included

Milk—fluid whole, evaporated, skim, dry, buttermilk.

Cheese—cottage; cream; Cheddar-type, natural or process.

Ice cream.



Amounts Recommended

Some milk every day for everyone.

Recommended amounts are given below in terms of 8-ounce cups of whole fluid milk:

Children under 9	2 to 3	Adults	2 or more
Children 9 to 12	3 or more	Pregnant women	3 or more
Teen-agers	4 or more	Nursing mothers	4 or more

Part or all of the milk may be fluid skim milk, buttermilk, evaporated milk, or dry milk.

Cheese and ice cream may replace part of the milk. The amount of either it will take to replace a given amount of milk is figured on the basis of calcium content. Common portions of cheese and of ice cream and their milk equivalents in calcium are:

1-inch cube Cheddar-type cheese	= ½ cup milk
½ cup cottage cheese	= ⅓ cup milk
2 tablespoons cream cheese	= 1 tablespoon milk
½ cup ice cream	= ¼ cup milk

BREAD-CEREAL GROUP

Foods Included

All breads and cereals that are whole grain, enriched, or restored; *check labels to be sure.*



Specifically, this group includes: Breads; cooked cereals; ready-to-eat cereals; cornmeal; crackers; flour; grits; macaroni and spaghetti; noodles; rice; rolled oats; and quick breads and other baked goods if made with whole-grain or enriched flour. Bulgur and parboiled rice and wheat also may be included in this group.

Amounts Recommended

Choose 4 servings or more daily. Or, if no cereals are chosen, have an extra serving of breads or baked goods, which will make at least 5 servings from this group daily.

Count as 1 serving: 1 slice of bread; 1 ounce ready-to-eat cereal; $\frac{1}{2}$ to $\frac{3}{4}$ cup cooked cereal, cornmeal, grits, macaroni, noodles, rice, or spaghetti.

OTHER FOODS

To round out meals and meet energy needs, almost everyone will use some foods not specified in the four food groups. Such foods include: unenriched, refined breads, cereals, flours; sugars; butter, margarine, other fats. These often are ingredients in a recipe or added to other foods during preparation or at the table.

Try to include some vegetable oil among the fats used.

Maintaining desirable weight

It is best to maintain desirable weight for one's height at all ages, even during childhood. Here are two principles that you can use—

- Reduce food intake as you become less active. Exercise and activity use up energy—or calories. If you cut down activity but not food, you are providing more energy than the body needs. The excess is stored as fat.
- Reduce food intake as you—as an adult—get older. As adults grow older, less energy is needed to keep the body functioning.

To reduce food intake without shortchanging the body of essential nutrients, follow the pattern of choices suggested by the Daily Food Guide. Weight watchers need the same types of food for health as everyone else.

Crash diets and food fads are not the answer and may be dangerous to health.

Cut down on food, but don't cut out any important kinds of foods.

Snacks are counted as a part of the day's total food. Sensible snacking can help meet nutritional needs, but indiscriminate eating between meals usually leads to more calories than are wanted, less of some nutrients than are needed.

Specific information on controlling weight is given in Home and Garden Bulletin 74, "Food and Your Weight." It includes basic weight-control facts, suggestions for reducing or gaining weight, meals and menus, and calorie values of common foods.

Tips on meal planning

Keep these points in mind when you plan meals for your family:

- Include a variety of foods each day and from day to day. Introduce a new food from time to time.
- Vary flavors and textures. Contrast strong flavor with mild, sweet with sour. Combine crisp textures with smooth.
- Try to have some meat, poultry, fish, eggs, milk or cheese at each meal.
- Make a collection of nutritious recipes that the family enjoys and serve them often.
- Brighten food with color—a slice of red tomato, a sprig of dark greens, or other garnish.
- Combine different sizes and shapes of food in a meal, when possible.

Servings and Pounds

If you are a thrifty food shopper, you learn to buy the kinds and amounts of food that your family will use—with a minimum of waste. To avoid waste and to make the most of your food dollar, you also need to know how many servings you get from a market unit, such as 1 pound of fresh carrots or a 10-ounce package of frozen peaches.

Information in this section can help you decide how much to buy to feed your family.

The amount of meat, poultry, and fish to buy varies with the amount of bone, fat, and breading.

Meat, poultry, and fish

	<i>Servings per pound</i> ^[1]
MEAT	
Much bone or gristle	1 or 2
Medium amounts of bone	2 or 3
Little or no bone	3 or 4
POULTRY (READY-TO-COOK)	
Chicken	2 or 3
Turkey	2 or 3
Duck and goose	2
FISH	
Whole	1 or 2
Dressed or pan-dressed	2 or 3
Portions or steaks	3
Fillets	3 or 4

FOOTNOTES:

[1] Three ounces of cooked lean meat, poultry, or fish per serving.

Vegetables and fruits

For this table, a serving of vegetable is $\frac{1}{2}$ cup cooked vegetable unless otherwise noted. A serving of fruit is $\frac{1}{2}$ cup fruit; 1 medium apple, banana, peach, or pear; or 2 apricots or plums. A serving of cooked fresh or dried fruit is $\frac{1}{2}$ cup fruit and liquid.

	<i>Servings per pound</i> ^[2]
FRESH VEGETABLES	
Asparagus	3 or 4
Beans, lima ^[2]	2
Beans, snap	5 or 6
Beets, diced ^[3]	3 or 4
Broccoli	3 or 4
Brussels sprouts	4 or 5
Cabbage:	
Raw, shredded	9 or 10
Cooked	4 or 5
Carrots:	
Raw, diced or shredded ^[3]	5 or 6
Cooked ^[3]	4
Cauliflower	3
Celery:	
Raw, chopped or diced	5 or 6
Cooked	4
Kale ^[4]	5 or 6
Okra	4 or 5
Onions, cooked	3 or 4

Parsnips ^[3]	4
Peas ^[5]	2
Potatoes	4
Spinach ^[6]	4
Squash, summer	3 or 4
Squash, winter	2 or 3
Sweetpotatoes	3 or 4
Tomatoes, raw, diced or sliced	4

FOOTNOTES:

^[2] As purchased.

^[3] Bought in pod.

^[4] Bought without tops.

^[5] Bought untrimmed.

^[6] Bought prepackaged.

*Servings
per package
(9 or 10 oz.)*

FROZEN VEGETABLES

Asparagus	2 or 3
Beans, lima	3 or 4
Beans, snap	3 or 4
Broccoli	3
Brussels sprouts	3
Cauliflower	3
Corn, whole kernel	3
Kale	2 or 3
Peas	3
Spinach	2 or 3

Servings

	<i>per can</i> <i>(1 lb.)</i>
--	----------------------------------

CANNED VEGETABLES

Most vegetables	3 or 4
Greens, such as kale or spinach	2 or 3

Servings
per pound

DRY VEGETABLES

Dry beans	11
Dry peas, lentils	10 or 11

Servings per
market unit^[7]

FRESH FRUIT

Apples	}	3 or 4 per pound
Bananas		
Peaches		
Pears		
Plums		
Apricots	}	5 or 6 per pound
Cherries, sweet		
Grapes, seedless		
Blueberries	}	4 or 5 per pint
Raspberries		
Strawberries		

FOOTNOTES:

^[7] As purchased.

Servings
per package
(10 or 12 oz.)

FROZEN FRUIT

Blueberries	3 or 4
Peaches	2 or 3
Raspberries	2 or 3
Strawberries	2 or 3

Servings

per can

(1 lb.)

CANNED FRUIT

Served with liquid	4
Drained	2 or 3

Servings

per package

(8 oz.)

DRIED FRUIT

Apples	8
Apricots	6
Mixed fruits	6
Peaches	7
Pears	4
Prunes	4 or 5

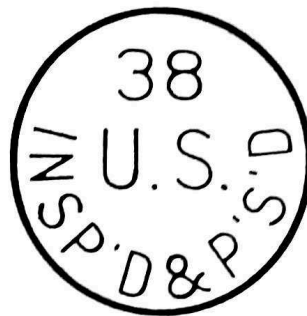
Smart Buying

Meat

Your best guides for selecting meat are the U.S. Department of Agriculture grades. Federally graded meats carry a purple grade stamp—a shield enclosing the letters “USDA” and the grade name. These stamps divide the wide range of meat quality into several groups.

Grade stamps appear on most retail beef, veal, calf, lamb, and mutton cuts. Pork is not usually graded. Some meat packers, wholesalers, and retailers use their own brand names to designate the quality levels of their products.

USDA Prime, the top grade, is used largely by hotels and restaurants. USDA Choice and USDA Good are the grades most commonly found in retail markets. USDA Standard and Commercial grades are not often sold at retail.



38
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USDA meat inspection marks.

Another purple stamp that may appear on fresh retail meat cuts is the circular mark of Federal meat inspection (below, left). This shows that meat is inspected and passed for wholesomeness, and that it is processed under strict sanitary conditions. A round mark of Federal meat inspection (below, right) also appears on processed meat products to show they are made from wholesome meat, are processed under sanitary conditions, and are truthfully labeled. All fresh or processed meat products that are shipped from one State to another must bear a mark of Federal inspection.

Not all meat is federally inspected. Some States and cities have their own regulations for locally produced meats. However, the Wholesome Meat Act of 1967 will ultimately assure consumers that all meat is inspected by either the Federal Government or an adequate State system.

Meat and your money

At the meat counter, consider the amount of cooked lean meat you will get for the money you pay.

The prices for a pound of beef chuck roast, pork rib roast, ground beef, and beef liver may be about the same at your store. In many instances, a pound of these roasts will provide only about half as much cooked lean meat as a pound of ground beef or beef liver. The other half of the pound of roast is bone, excess fat, and drippings.

So it would take twice as many pounds—and twice as much money—to feed your family the roasts as it would the ground beef or liver, even though the price per pound is the same.

Poultry

In retail markets, ready-to-cook poultry is available chilled or frozen, whole or cut up. Processed poultry products are also on the market in canned, frozen, dehydrated, and other convenient forms.



USDA poultry inspection and grademarks.

Look for both the round U.S. Department of Agriculture inspection mark and the shield-shaped grademark on the poultry you buy.

The round USDA inspection mark (above, left) means that poultry and poultry products have been officially inspected for wholesomeness, are truthfully labeled, and are not adulterated. USDA inspection is required in plants that produce poultry products for sale across State lines or in foreign trade.

The shield-shaped grademark (above, right) shows that the poultry has been officially graded for quality. Poultry must be USDA-inspected before it can be federally graded. The U.S. grades for poultry are based on meatiness, freedom from defects, and general appearance. The best grade of poultry is marked “USDA Grade A.”

Chicken, turkey, duck, and goose are common forms of poultry. Guinea is available in some markets. The label may suggest suitable cooking methods and indicate the age of the poultry—for chicken: “broiler or fryer,” “roaster,” “stewing chicken;” for turkey: “fryer-roaster,” “young hen,” “young tom,” “mature turkey.”

Types of poultry

Broilers, fryers, roasters, capons, and Rock Cornish game hens are young chickens with tender meat. Stewing chickens, hens, and fowl are mature chickens with less tender meat. Turkeys labeled fryer-roaster or young turkey are young birds with tender meat. Most ducks are marketed young as

ducklings—broilers, fryers, and roasters. Most geese and guineas are marketed as young geese and young guineas.

Ready-to-cook chickens are sold chilled or frozen—whole or cut into parts. Most ready-to-cook turkeys are marketed frozen whole, in a wide range of sizes; some are available chilled. Frozen turkey halves, quarters, or parts are sometimes available. Ducks, geese, and guineas—like turkeys—are generally marketed frozen whole. Ducklings are also available as cut-up parts.

Frozen poultry, stuffed and ready for the oven, is available in many markets. Boneless poultry roasts and rolls—so convenient—are also on the market.

Fish

Today there are about 240 commercial species of fish and shellfish marketed in the United States. They may be fresh, frozen, or canned.

Fresh fish are generally available by the pound in these forms—whole, dressed, and in steaks, fillets, and chunks. Most fish dealers will clean, dress, or fillet your fish for you. They can also tell you what fish are in season and what fish are a good buy.

Frozen fish are usually packed during the season when they are plentiful and are held in freezer storage until distributed. This means that you can buy most fish throughout the year. Frozen fish come whole, dressed, and in steaks, fillets, chunks, portions, and sticks.

Canned fish and specialty items containing fish are ready to serve or use as bought. Canned tuna, salmon, mackerel, and Maine sardines are widely available.

Market forms

Familiarize yourself with these market forms of fish:

Whole.—Fish marketed just as they come from the water. Ask your dealer to scale, eviscerate, and remove head, tail, and fins.

Dressed or pan-dressed.—Fish with scales and entrails removed, and—usually—head, tail, and fins removed. Small fish are called pan-dressed and are ready to cook as purchased. Large dressed fish may be cooked as purchased, but often are filleted or cut into steaks or chunks.

Steaks.—Cross-section slices from large dressed fish cut $\frac{5}{8}$ to 1 inch thick. Steaks can be cooked as purchased.

Fillets.—Sides of the fish cut lengthwise away from the backbone. They may be skinned or the skin may be left on. Fillets are ready to cook as purchased.

Chunks.—Cross sections of large dressed fish. A cross section of the backbone is the only bone in a chunk. They are ready to cook as purchased.

Raw breaded fish portions.—Portions cut from frozen fish blocks, coated with a batter, breaded, packaged, and frozen. Raw breaded fish portions weigh more than 1½ ounces. They are ready to cook as purchased.

Fried fish portions.—Portions cut from frozen fish blocks, coated with a batter, breaded, partially cooked, packaged, and frozen. Fried fish portions weigh more than 1½ ounces. They are ready to heat and serve as purchased.

Fried fish sticks.—Sticks cut from frozen fish blocks, coated with a batter, breaded, partially cooked, packaged, and frozen. Fried fish sticks weigh up to 1½ ounces. They are ready to heat and serve as purchased.

Inspection and grading

The U.S. Department of the Interior provides an official inspection service that enables you to identify high-quality seafoods. Such products may be identified by the official USDI grade or inspection shields that appear on the label. Fishery products that display these shields have been processed under continuous in-plant inspection and have met definite quality, processing, and packaging requirements.

Eggs

Buy graded eggs in cartons at a store that keeps them in refrigerated cases. Federally graded eggs are identified with a shield-shaped grademark

that indicates the quality at the time of grading. If they have been properly handled since grading, there should be little loss in quality.

Quality.—U.S. Grade AA (or Fresh Fancy) and Grade A eggs are excellent for all purposes, but are especially good for poaching and frying where the appearance of the finished product is important. Grade B eggs are satisfactory for use in cooked dishes.

The grade of the egg does not affect its food value; lower grades are as high in nutrients as top grades. Buy either white or brown eggs. The color of the shell does not affect the nutritive value or quality of the egg.

Size.—Eggs are also classified by size according to weight per dozen. Size is independent of quality; large eggs may be of high or low quality and high-quality eggs may be of any size. Common market sizes of eggs and the minimum weight per dozen:

U.S. Extra Large—27 ounces.

U.S. Large—24 ounces.

U.S. Medium—21 ounces.

U.S. Small—18 ounces.

The substitution of one size egg for another often makes little difference in recipe results. However, in some recipes—for example in sponge and angelfood cakes—the proportion of egg to other ingredients is very important. For these recipes, it may be necessary to increase the number of eggs if you are using a smaller size.

Fresh fruits and vegetables

Fresh fruits and vegetables are usually best in quality and lowest in cost when in season.

Whatever fruit or vegetable you are buying, look first for freshness. Pointers on selecting some fruits and vegetables follow on page [12](#).

Fruits

Apples.—Good color usually indicates full flavor.

Bananas.—Bananas should be firm, fresh in appearance, and unscarred. Yellow or brown-flecked ones are ready for immediate use. Select slightly green-colored bananas for use within a few days.

Berries.—Select plump, solid berries with good color. Avoid wet or leaky berries. Blackberries and raspberries with clinging caps may be underripe. Strawberries without caps may be too ripe.

Grapes.—Grapes should be plump, fresh in appearance, and firmly attached to the stems. Red or black varieties should be well colored for the variety. Most white or green varieties should have a slightly amber tone.

Melons (except watermelons).—Ripe cantaloups have a yellowish surface color; honeydews, a creamy color; crenshaws, a golden-yellow color mottled with green; casabas, a yellow color; and persian melons, a dull gray-green color. Ripe melons of these types usually have a fruity aroma and a slight softening at the blossom end. A ripe cantaloup has no stem; other melons may have stems attached.

Oranges, grapefruit, and lemons.—Choose those heavy for their size. Smooth, thin skins usually indicate more juice. Most skin markings do not affect quality. Oranges with a slight greenish tinge may be just as ripe as fully colored ones. Light or greenish-yellow lemons are more tart than deep-yellow ones.

Peaches.—Best quality peaches are fairly firm, not bruised, with yellow or red color over the entire surface.

Pears.—Some pears, especially winter varieties, are marketed when slightly underripe and need to be ripened at home—at room temperature. Pears are ripe and ready to eat when they yield slightly to moderate pressure.

Pineapples.—Pineapple varieties vary greatly in color. Ripe pineapples have a fragrant, fruity aroma. Usually, the heavier the fruit for its size, the better the quality. Avoid pineapples that have decayed or moldy spots.

Watermelons.—Ripe watermelons have a somewhat dull surface and a creamy color underneath. The interior should be fully red and firm, and should have few immature seeds.

Vegetables

Asparagus.—Stalks should be tender and firm; tips should be close and compact. Choose the stalks with little white—they are more tender. Use asparagus promptly—it toughens rapidly.

Beans, snap.—Choose slender beans with no large bumps (bumps indicate large seeds). Avoid beans with dry-looking pods.

Broccoli.—Look for small flower buds on compactly arranged heads with good green color. Avoid yellowing, soft, or spreading heads.

Brussels sprouts.—The heads should be firm with good green color. Yellowing outer leaves and softness indicate aging. Smudgy, dirty spots may indicate insect damage or decay.

Cabbage.—Choose heads that are firm and heavy. Outer leaves should be fresh, green, and free from worm-holes.

Cauliflower.—Choose heads that are compact, firm, and white or creamy white. Avoid discolored heads and those with soft spots.

Celery.—Best-quality celery is fresh and crisp. It is clean and has leaves that appear fresh; stems do not have black or brown discoloration. Avoid pithy, woody, or very stringy celery.

Corn.—Good-quality fresh corn has husks that are fresh and green. The ears are well filled with plump, firm, milky kernels. Immature ears of corn have small, undeveloped, watery kernels. Overmature ears have very firm, large, starchy kernels, often indented.

Cucumbers.—Choose firm, slender cucumbers for best quality. Avoid yellowed cucumbers and those with withered or shrivelled ends.

Lettuce (head).—Select heads that are green, fresh, crisp, and fairly firm to firm. Head lettuce should be free from rusty appearance and excessive outer leaves.

Onions (dry).—Size and color do not affect flavor or quality of dry onions. Clean, hard, well-shaped onions with dry skins are usually of good quality. Moisture at the neck may be a sign of decay. Mild-flavored onions,

which are often large, may be elongated or flat. Stronger-flavored onions are usually medium size and globe shaped.

Peas and lima beans.—Select pods that are well filled but not bulging. Avoid dried, spotted, yellowed, or flabby pods.

Potatoes.—Best-quality potatoes are firm, smooth, and well shaped. They are free from cuts, blemishes, and decay. To judge quality more easily, look for potatoes that are reasonably clean. Avoid potatoes with wasteful deep eyes. Potatoes with green skins may be bitter. If you plan to buy a large quantity of potatoes, buy a few first to see if they are the kind you want. Early-crop potatoes, harvested in spring and summer, tend to be less mealy when cooked than those harvested later.

Root vegetables.—Choose smooth, firm vegetables. Very large carrots may have woody cores; oversized radishes may be pithy; oversized turnips, beets, and parsnips may be woody. The size and condition of the tops on root vegetables do not necessarily indicate the eating quality.

Sweetpotatoes.—Choose sweetpotatoes that are clean, smooth, well shaped, and firm. Damp or soft spots may indicate decay. There are two types of sweetpotatoes. The moist type has soft, moist, orange-colored flesh and bronze or rosy skin. The dry type has firm, dry, somewhat mealy, yellow-colored flesh and yellow or light-brown skin.

Tomatoes.—Choose tomatoes that are plump, firm, and uniformly pink, red, or yellow in color. They should be free from growth cracks, scars, and bruises. The best flavored tomatoes are ripened on the vine.

For more information, see Home and Garden Bulletins 141, “How to Buy Fresh Fruits,” and 143, “How to Buy Fresh Vegetables.”

Canned and frozen foods

Canned.—You may want to choose the highest quality for salads, or for serving “as is.” But second quality may do for combination dishes such as stews, casserole dishes, soups, and fruit puddings, where uniform size, shape, or color is not important.

Frozen.—Buy only packages that are frozen solid. Avoid partially thawed packages that feel soft or are stained. Thawing and refreezing lower quality.

Wise Storing

Meat, poultry, and fish

All meat should be promptly refrigerated.

The transparent wrap on prepackaged meat, poultry, or fish is designed for refrigerator storage at home for 1 or 2 days.

Meat or poultry wrapped in meat paper when brought from the store—or prepackaged roasts and steaks that may be stored in the refrigerator for 3 to 5 days—should be unwrapped, placed on a platter or tray, and loosely covered before refrigerating. Wrap and store fish separately from other foods. Poultry giblets should also be wrapped and stored separately.

Keep cooked meat, poultry, and fish, and the gravy or broth made from them, in covered containers in the refrigerator. Use within 1 or 2 days.

Cured and smoked meats.—ham, frankfurters, bacon, sausage—can be stored in their original containers in the refrigerator. Mild-cured hams are similar to fresh meats in keeping quality. Use whole hams within a week, half hams and slices within 3 to 5 days. For best flavor, use bacon, franks, and smoked sausages within a week.

Eggs

To help maintain quality, store eggs in the refrigerator promptly after purchase—large end up.

For best flavor and cooking quality, use eggs within 1 week if possible. Eggs held in the refrigerator for a long time may develop off-flavors and lose some thickening and leavening power.

Cover leftover yolks with cold water and refrigerate in a tightly covered container. Refrigerate leftover egg whites, too, in a tightly covered container. Use leftover yolks or whites within 1 or 2 days.

Fresh fruits and vegetables

Fresh fruits should be ripe when stored in the refrigerator. Some unripe fruits will ripen if left for a time at room temperature—preferably in a cool room between 60° and 70° F.

Keep bananas at room temperature. They will turn dull brown if refrigerated. Sort berries and cherries; then refrigerate, unwashed. Use promptly. Refrigerate ripe pineapples.

Sweet corn keeps best if refrigerated uncovered in husks; use it promptly. Removing tops from carrots, beets, and radishes reduces wilting. Storing potatoes in a cool, dark place prevents greening.

STORAGE GUIDE FOR FRUITS AND VEGETABLES.

Hold at room temperature until ripe; then refrigerate, uncovered:

Apples
Apricots
Avocados
Berries
Cherries
Grapes
Melons, except watermelons
Nectarines
Peaches
Pears
Plums
Tomatoes

Store in cool room or refrigerate, uncovered:

Grapefruit
Lemons
Limes
Oranges

Store in cool room, away from bright light:

Onions, mature
Potatoes
Rutabagas
Squash, winter
Sweetpotatoes

Refrigerate, covered:

Asparagus
Beans, snap or wax
Beets
Broccoli
Cabbage
Carrots
Cauliflower
Celery
Corn, husked
Cucumbers
Greens
Onions, green
Parsnips
Peas, shelled
Peppers, green
Radishes
Squash, summer
Turnips

Refrigerate, uncovered:

Beans, lima, in pods
Corn, in husks
Peas, in pods
Pineapples
Watermelons

Fats and oils

Refrigerate lard, butter, margarine, drippings, and opened containers of cooking and salad oils. You can store most firm vegetable shortenings

(those that have been hydrogenated), covered, at room temperature. Refrigerate opened jars of salad dressing; do not freeze.

Canned, frozen, and dried foods

Canned foods.—Store in a dry place at room temperature (not above 70° F.).

Frozen foods.—Can be stored in freezing unit of refrigerator up to 1 week. For longer storage, keep in a freezer at 0° F.

Dried foods.—Store *dried fruits* in tightly closed containers at room temperature (not above 70° F.). In warm, humid weather, refrigerate.

Store *nonfat dry milk* in a closed container at a temperature of 75° F., or lower. Because of its higher milkfat content, *dry whole milk* does not keep as well as nonfat dry milk. Keep dry whole milk in a tightly closed container in the refrigerator. Refrigerate *reconstituted dry milk* as you would fresh fluid milk.

Ingredients and Measurements

About ingredients

Ingredients that may be used in place of other ingredients are listed on the next page.

Recipes in this bulletin were tested with the ingredients listed. Sometimes a choice of ingredients is given in the recipe or under Variations of the recipe.

“Flour” refers to *all-purpose flour, unsifted*. In a few recipes, where “cake flour” is specified it is also unsifted. Recipes in this bulletin are not intended for use with either instantized or self-rising flour.

“Baking powder” refers to *double-acting baking powder* that leavens during mixing and again during baking. Quick-acting baking powder (containing cream of tartar) is single-acting; it can be used most satisfactorily in foods that are mixed and baked immediately. (See One Ingredient For Another, p. [17](#), for amounts.)

“Fat or oil” refers to any type—butter, margarine, shortening, lard, or any kind of vegetable oil. In recipes specifying a particular type of fat—“butter or margarine,” for example—you’ll have best results with the fat suggested. Recipes in this bulletin are not intended for use with whipped fats.

Measuring foods

All measurements given in this bulletin are level.

Frequently used food measurements are given below.

1 tablespoon = 3 teaspoons

1 fluid ounce = 2 tablespoons

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup = 4 tablespoons

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup = $5\frac{1}{3}$ tablespoons

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup = 8 tablespoons

$\frac{2}{3}$ cup = $10\frac{2}{3}$ tablespoons

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup = 12 tablespoons

1 cup = 16 tablespoons or 8 fluid ounces

1 pint = 2 cups

1 quart = 2 pints or 4 cups

Part of cup.—Use tablespoons or small measures— $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{1}{3}$, $\frac{1}{4}$ cup—for greater accuracy.

Brown sugar.—Pack firmly into cup or spoon and level off top with straight, thin edge of spatula or knife.

Solid fats.—Pack fat firmly into cup or smaller measure and level off top with straight, thin edge of spatula or knife.

To measure less than 1 cup, you can also use the water method: Partly fill a cup with cold water, leaving enough space for the amount of fat needed. (To measure $\frac{1}{4}$ cup of fat, for example, fill cup with water to $\frac{3}{4}$ mark.) Spoon fat into cup, push under water until water level reaches 1-cup mark. Drain thoroughly before using fat.

For solid fat in sticks or pounds, cut off amount needed. A 1-pound form measures about 2 cups; a $\frac{1}{4}$ -pound stick of butter or margarine measures $\frac{1}{2}$ cup.

Flour.—Spoon flour lightly into measuring cup until measure is overflowing. Do not shake or tap cup. Level off top with straight, thin edge of spatula or knife.

Fine meal, fine crumbs.—Stir lightly with fork or spoon. Measure like flour.

Baking powder, cornstarch, cream of tartar, spices.—Dip spoon into container and bring it up heaping full. Level off top with straight, thin edge of spatula or knife.

Dry milk.—Pour dry milk from spout or opening in package, or spoon lightly, into measuring cup until measure is overflowing. Do not shake. Level off top with straight, thin edge of spatula or knife.

ONE INGREDIENT FOR ANOTHER

For these**You may use these**

1 whole egg, for baking or thickening

- 2 egg yolks.

1 cup butter or margarine for baking

- $\frac{7}{8}$ cup vegetable or animal shortening plus $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt.

1 ounce unsweetened chocolate

- 3 tablespoons cocoa plus 1 tablespoon fat.

1 teaspoon double-acting baking powder

- 2 teaspoons quick-acting baking powder.
- $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon baking soda plus $\frac{1}{2}$ cup sour milk or buttermilk instead of $\frac{1}{2}$ cup sweet milk.

1 cup buttermilk or sour milk, for baking

- 1 cup fluid whole milk plus 1 tablespoon vinegar or lemon juice.
- 1 cup fluid whole milk plus $1\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoons cream of tartar.

1 cup fluid whole milk

- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup evaporated milk plus $\frac{1}{2}$ cup water.
- 1 cup reconstituted nonfat dry milk plus
- $2\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoons butter or margarine.

1 cup fluid skim milk

- 1 cup reconstituted nonfat dry milk.

1 tablespoon flour, for thickening

- $\frac{1}{2}$ tablespoon cornstarch.
- 2 teaspoons quick-cooking tapioca.

1 cup cake flour, for baking

- $\frac{7}{8}$ cup all-purpose flour.

NOTE: Seven-eighths cup equals 1 level cup minus 2 tablespoons.

Main Dishes

Foods that abound in protein—meat, poultry, fish, eggs, and cheese—make satisfying main dishes. Thrifty main dishes often combine these protein-rich foods with vegetables and cereals—beef stew with vegetables or dumplings, chicken with rice, fish with stuffing, cheese with macaroni.

Dry beans and peas are also economical choices for main dishes.

If the main dish is not high in protein, you can supply additional protein with other foods in the meal. If, for example, a pound of meat is to serve eight persons, you might combine it with vegetables or cereal in a casserole or stew, have milk to drink, and serve cheese-topped apple pie for dessert.

Meat

Meat cooked at low to moderate temperatures is more tender, juicy, and flavorful than meat cooked at high temperatures. There is more meat to serve because there is less shrinkage at low temperatures.

Beef may be cooked rare, medium, or well done. Lamb is enjoyed either medium or well done, but veal and pork are usually cooked well done.

Broiling, pan-frying, and roasting are recommended for tender meats only. Less tender cuts are more satisfactory if braised, pot-roasted, or simmered. For suggested methods for cooking, see guide on [page [19](#)].

Frozen meat need not be thawed before cooking, but extra cooking time will be required if it is not thawed first.

Roasting ... beef, veal, lamb, pork

Place roast, fat side up, on a rack in a shallow pan. Do not add water; do not cover. Season either before or after cooking.

Check the timetable (p. [20](#)) for approximate roasting times. The quality of the meat, its size and shape, and its temperature at the start of cooking will affect the roasting time. Times given here are for meats at refrigerator

temperature. Frozen roasts may take 1½ to 2 times as long to cook as unfrozen roasts of the same weight and shape.

If you are using a meat thermometer, insert it so the tip is at the center of the thickest part of the roast, and not touching bone or fat.

Broiling ... beef, lamb, cured ham

Slash fat around edge of meat to prevent curling. Place meat on cold broiler grid.

Broiling temperature can be regulated by the distance meat is placed from heat source and whether the door is open or closed during broiling. Because broilers vary widely, follow the manufacturer's directions. If you like meat well done, place it farther from the heat source than for medium or rare meat—to avoid burning the outside before the center is cooked. Place thicker cuts farther from the heat source than thin ones, for the same reason.

MEAT COOKING GUIDE

BEEF	VEAL	LAMB	PORK
ROASTING			
Chuck or shoulder	Loin	Leg	Fresh and cured ham
Rib	Leg	Loin	Fresh and cured shoulder
Round	Shoulder	Rib	Loin
Rump		Shoulder	Spareribs
Sirloin			
Sirloin tip			
Tenderloin			
BROILING			
Patties (ground)	Liver	Chops	Bacon
Thick steaks:		Liver	Canadian bacon
Chuck		Patties (ground)	Chops
Club			Cured ham slices
Porterhouse			
Rib			
Top round			
Sirloin			
T-bone			

PAN-BROILING, PAN-FRYING

Liver	Cube steaks	Chops	Bacon
Patties (ground)	Liver	Liver	Canadian bacon
Thin steaks:	Patties (ground)	Patties (ground)	Cured ham slices
Club	Cutlets or round steak		Liver
Cube steaks	Loin and rib chops		Thin chops
Porterhouse			Thin steaks
Rib			
Round			
Sirloin			
T-bone			

BRAISING, POT-ROASTING

Chuck or shoulder	Cutlets	Breast	Chops
Flank	Loin and rib chops	Neck slices	Ham slices
Liver	Roasts:	Shanks	Liver
Round	Round	Shortribs	Shanks
Rump	Rump	Shoulder cuts	Spareribs
Shortribs	Shoulder		Steaks
Sirloin tip			Tenderloin

SIMMERING, STEWING

Brisket	Breast	Breast	Cured ham
Corned beef	Riblets	Neck slices	Cured shoulder
Heel of round	Shanks	Shanks	Hocks
Neck			Shanks
Shanks			Spareribs
Shortribs			

TIMETABLE FOR ROASTING MEATS

Kind and cut of meat	Ready-to-cook weight	Approximate roasting time at 325°F.	Internal temperature of meat when done
BEEF			
Standing ribs:	<i>Pounds</i>	<i>Hours</i>	<i>°F.</i>
Rare	6 to 8	2½ to 3	140
Medium	6 to 8	3 to 3½	160
Well done	6 to 8	3¾ to 5	170
Rolled rump:			
Rare	5	2¼	140
Medium	5	3	160
Well done	5	3¼	170
Sirloin tip:			

Rare	3	1½	140
Medium	3	2	160
Well done	3	2¼	170
VEAL			
Leg	5 to 8	2½ to 3½	170
Loin	5	3	170
Shoulder	6	3½	170
LAMB			
Leg (whole)	6 to 7	3¼ to 4	180
Shoulder	3 to 6	2¼ to 3¼	180
Rolled shoulder	3 to 5	2½ to 3	180
PORK, FRESH			
Loin	3 to 5	2 to 4	170
Shoulder	5 to 8	3½ to 5	185
Ham, whole	10 to 14	5½ to 6	185
Ham, half	6	4	185
Spareribs	3	2	185
PORK, CURED			
Cook-before-eating:			
Ham, whole	12 to 16	3½ to 4¼	160
Ham, half	6	2½	160
Picnic shoulder	6	3½	170
Fully cooked: ^[8]			
Ham, whole	12 to 16	3 to 3¾	130
Ham, half	6	1½ to 2	130

FOOTNOTES:

^[8] Can also be served without heating, if desired.

Broil until top side of meat is browned, about half of total cooking time. Season, turn, and brown other side. Use timetable (next page) as a guide to total broiling time. To tell if meat is done, cut into it along bone and observe color.

Use a low temperature for broiling frozen meat, so the surface does not char before the interior thaws and cooks. Allow 1½ to 2 times as long as specified in the timetable on page [21](#).

Pan broiling ... beef, lamb, pork

Choose thin steaks, chops, or ham slices (1 inch thick or less). Or shape meat patties less than an inch thick.

Slash fat around edge of meat to prevent it from curling. Grease pan lightly with fat or rub pan with fat edge of meat.

Cook meat slowly over moderate heat, turning occasionally as necessary. Pour off excess fat as it accumulates. Total cooking time will be 10 to 20 minutes, depending on the degree of doneness desired. Pork chops may take a little longer.

Remove meat from pan, season, and serve.

Braising ... beef, veal, lamb, pork

Brown meat slowly on all sides in enough added fat to keep meat from sticking. Use a heavy pan. Meats may be floured or not, as desired, before browning. Floured meats brown better than unfloured meats. Meats that have a considerable amount of fat and that are not floured can be browned without added fat.

Season the meat. If necessary to prevent overbrowning, add a small amount of liquid (about $\frac{1}{2}$ cup for a roast). Many cuts of meat can be braised without added liquid. Steam from meat juices trapped in a covered pan provides enough moisture. Cover pan tightly.

Cook slowly over low heat or in a 350° F. oven until tender, adding more liquid if needed. Use the timetable (p. [22](#)) as a guide to braising time.

TIMETABLE FOR BROILING MEATS

Kind and cut of meat	Approximate thickness	Degree of doneness	Approximate total cooking time ^[9]
	<i>Inches</i>		<i>Minutes</i>
Beef steaks	1	Rare	10 to 15

(Club, porterhouse, rib, sirloin, T-bone, tenderloin)	1	Medium	15 to 20
	1	Well done	20 to 30
	1½	Rare	15 to 20
	1½	Medium	20 to 25
	1½	Well done	25 to 40
	2	Rare	25 to 35
	2	Medium	35 to 45
	2	Well done	45 to 55
Hamburgers	¾	Rare	8
	¾	Medium	12
	¾	Well done	14
Lamb chops	1	Medium	12
(Loin, rib, shoulder)	1	Well done	14
	1½	Medium	18
	1½	Well done	22
Cured ham slices	¾	Well done	13 to 14
(Cook-before-eating)	1	Well done	18 to 20

FOOTNOTES:

[\[9\]](#) Meat at refrigerator temperature at start of broiling.

TIMETABLE FOR BRAISING MEATS

Kind and cut of meat	Approximate ready-to-cook weight or thickness	Approximate total cooking time
BEEF		
Pot roast, such as chuck or round	3 to 5 pounds	<i>Hours</i> 3 to 4
Steak, such as chuck or round	1 to 1½ inches	2 to 2½
Short ribs	2 to 2½ pounds	2 to 2½
VEAL		
Chops	½ to ¾ inch	¾

Shoulder, rolled	3 to 5 pounds	2 to 2½
LAMB		
Chops	½ to ¾ inch	½ to ¾
Shanks	1 pound each	1½ to 2
Shoulder, rolled	3 to 5 pounds	2 to 2½
PORK		
Chops	½ to 1 inch	¾ to 1
Spareribs	2 to 3 pounds	1½ to 2½

Quick beef pie

6 servings

1½ pounds ground beef
 1 medium-size onion, chopped
 ½ teaspoon salt
 1 can (10½ ounces) condensed tomato soup
 1 can (1 pound) cut green beans, drained
 ¼ teaspoon pepper
 1½ cups seasoned mashed potatoes
 ½ cup shredded Cheddar cheese

Crumble beef into large frypan. Add onion and salt, and cook until browned. Drain off excess fat.

Add soup, green beans, and pepper; simmer 5 minutes. Pour into greased 2-quart casserole.

Drop potatoes in mounds onto hot meat mixture. Sprinkle with cheese. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 20 minutes.

Menu suggestion

Serve with buttered carrots, stuffed prune salad, and brownies.

Beef stroganoff

6 servings

⅓ cup flour
 1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon pepper
1 pound sirloin tip steak, cut in very thin strips
½ cup finely chopped onion
¼ cup fat or oil
1 can (10½ ounces) condensed cream of mushroom soup
1 can (8 ounces) sliced mushrooms, drained
1 cup sour cream
Cooked rice
Paprika
Parsley

Combine flour, salt, and pepper. Coat meat strips with flour mixture. Brown meat in hot fat in a large frypan. Add onion and cook until clear. Drain off excess fat.

Add soup and mushrooms. Simmer, covered, 10 to 15 minutes. Blend in sour cream and remove from heat. Serve over rice. Sprinkle with paprika and garnish with parsley.

Menu suggestion

Serve with green beans, cucumber and tomato salad, and have sliced peaches and poundcake for dessert.

Luncheon special

6 servings

2 cups medium white sauce (p. [57](#))
2 cups shredded Cheddar cheese
1 package (10 ounces) frozen cut green beans, cooked and drained
1 can (12 ounces) luncheon meat, cut in thin strips
1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
White pepper, as desired
Toast triangles

To hot white sauce, add remaining ingredients except toast. Cook over low heat 10 minutes, or just until cheese melts and mixture is hot. Serve on toast triangles.

Menu suggestion

Serve with glazed carrots, fruit salad, and chocolate pudding.

Curried meat

6 servings

- 2 beef bouillon cubes
- 1½ cups hot water
- 1½ cups sliced celery
- 2 tablespoons chopped onion
- 3 tablespoons fat or oil
- 1 tablespoon cornstarch
- 1 teaspoon curry powder
- ½ teaspoon salt
- 3 cups chopped, cooked lamb, pork, or veal

Dissolve bouillon cubes in hot water.

Lightly brown celery and onion in hot fat in a large frypan. Blend in cornstarch and seasonings. Slowly stir in bouillon. Add meat. Cook mixture over moderate heat 15 to 20 minutes, stirring as needed to prevent sticking. Serve on rice.

Menu suggestion

Serve with italian green beans, citrus fruit salad, and spiced prune cake.

Sausage and potatoes au gratin

6 servings

- 1 can (10½ ounces) condensed cream of mushroom soup
- ½ cup milk
- ½ cup finely chopped onion
- ¼ cup chopped green pepper
- 1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon pepper
- 4 cups thinly sliced potatoes
- 1 package (8 ounces) precooked small smoked sausages, cut in bite-size

pieces

1 tablespoon butter or margarine

½ cup shredded Cheddar cheese

Combine soup, milk, onion, green pepper, pimiento, salt, and pepper; blend well.

Place half the potatoes in a greased 2-quart casserole. Add half the sausage. Cover with half the soup mixture. Repeat layers. Dot with fat. Cover and bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) about 1¼ hours.

Remove cover. Sprinkle with cheese and bake, uncovered, 15 minutes more, or until potatoes are tender.

Menu suggestion

Serve with brussels sprouts, fruit, and gingerbread.

Ham patties

6 servings

2 cups ground cooked ham

1 cup mashed potatoes

1 tablespoon chopped onion

¼ teaspoon dry mustard

¼ teaspoon salt

1 tablespoon milk

1 egg, beaten

½ cup fine dry breadcrumbs

3 tablespoons fat or oil

Combine ground ham, mashed potatoes, onion, mustard, and ¼ teaspoon salt. Chill about 1 hour. Shape into 12 patties.

Blend milk into beaten egg. Dip patties in egg mixture and then in crumbs.

Fry patties in hot fat until golden brown. Serve with egg sauce (p. [57](#)).

Menu suggestion

Serve with asparagus, molded fruit salad, cheese biscuits, and peanut butter cookies.

Braised liver and onions

6 servings

1½ pounds sliced beef liver

½ cup flour

2 tablespoons fat or oil

1½ teaspoons salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

1 large onion, sliced

¼ cup water

Remove skin and large veins from liver. Coat meat with flour. Heat fat in large frypan over moderate heat and brown liver on one side.

Turn liver, sprinkle with seasonings and cover with onions. Add water and cover pan tightly. Cook over low heat 20 to 30 minutes, or until liver is tender.

Menu suggestion

Serve with stewed okra and tomatoes, spinach salad, and apple crisp.

Spaghetti with meat sauce

6 servings

1 pound ground beef

1 medium-size onion, finely chopped

1 clove garlic, peeled

½ teaspoon oregano

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

1 can (6 ounces) tomato paste

¾ cup water

1 can (15 ounces) spanish-style tomato sauce

1 bay leaf

1 tablespoon sugar
4 cups cooked spaghetti
½ cup grated Parmesan or Romano cheese

Crumble ground beef into 4-quart saucepan. Add onion, garlic, oregano, salt, and pepper. Heat to brown meat.

Add tomato paste, water, tomato sauce, and bay leaf. Bring to a boil. Then simmer, uncovered, over low heat 45 minutes. Remove garlic. Add sugar and simmer 15 minutes longer.

Place hot spaghetti on a platter. Cover with meat sauce. Sprinkle with cheese.

Menu suggestion

Serve with tossed green salad and upside-down cake.

Meat loaf

6 servings

1½ pounds ground beef
3 slices soft white bread, torn into very small pieces
1 cup tomato juice or milk
½ cup finely chopped onion
1 egg, beaten
1 teaspoon salt
¼ teaspoon pepper

Mix ingredients thoroughly. Press into a 9- by 5- by 3-inch loafpan or shape into loaf.

Bake uncovered at 350° F. (moderate oven) about 1½ hours. Remove from oven and drain off excess fat.

Menu suggestion

Serve with green bean-mushroom casserole, baked potatoes, celery sticks and olives, and orange sherbet.

Stuffed green peppers

6 servings

3 large green peppers

2 teaspoons salt

Boiling water

1 pound ground beef

1½ cups cooked rice

2 tablespoons finely chopped celery

2 tablespoons finely chopped onion

¼ cup chili sauce

2 teaspoons salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

1 egg

2 tablespoons shredded Cheddar cheese

Halve peppers lengthwise; remove stems, seeds, and membranes. Add 2 teaspoons salt to enough boiling water to cover peppers; boil peppers 5 minutes. Drain.

Combine other ingredients except cheese; mix well. Fill pepper halves with this mixture and place in ½ inch of hot water in a baking pan.

Bake uncovered at 350° F. (moderate oven) 45 to 55 minutes. Sprinkle cheese over peppers and bake 5 minutes longer, or just until cheese melts.

Menu suggestion

Serve with corn pudding and coleslaw, and have your favorite ice cream for dessert.

Saucy luncheon meat

6 servings

2 packages (3 ounces each) cream cheese

2 tablespoons milk

1 pound bologna or other luncheon meat, finely diced

¼ cup finely chopped onion

2 tablespoons sliced ripe olives

2 teaspoons prepared mustard

¾ cup canned condensed cream of mushroom soup
Biscuits, cooked rice, or noodles

Blend cream cheese with milk in top of double boiler. Add meat, onion, olives, mustard, and soup; mix thoroughly. Heat over simmering water 15 to 20 minutes, stirring occasionally. Serve over biscuits, rice, or noodles.

Menu suggestion

Serve with kale, carrot and pineapple salad, and chocolate chip cookies.

Beef stew

6 servings

⅓ cup flour
1½ teaspoons salt
⅛ teaspoon pepper
1½ pounds boneless stew beef, cut in 1-inch cubes
2 tablespoons fat or oil
3 cups water
3 medium-size onions, sliced
4 medium-size potatoes, cut in 1-inch cubes
5 medium-size carrots, quartered
1½ cups frozen peas
¼ cup water

Combine flour, salt, and pepper; coat meat with seasoned flour. Save remaining flour. Brown meat in hot fat in a 4-quart saucepan.

Add water and cover tightly. Simmer until meat is tender, about 1½ hours.

Add onions, potatoes, and carrots. Cover and simmer 15 minutes.

Add peas. Cover and simmer until all vegetables are tender.

Blend ¼ cup water with remaining flour. Add to stew, stirring gently; cook until thickened.

Variation

Irish stew.—Use lean lamb instead of beef. Add 1 turnip, diced, with potatoes and carrots.

Menu suggestion

Serve with tossed green salad and hot biscuits. Have fruit sherbet and cookies for dessert.

Poultry

Serve poultry often—it's versatile, flavorful, and economical. You can buy chicken and turkey in convenient sizes—chilled or frozen—any day of the year. And for variety, try duck and goose.

Preparing poultry

Ready-to-cook poultry needs little preparation before cooking. Inspect for pinfeathers. Wash and drain poultry.

Keep *frozen poultry* frozen until time to thaw or cook. Frozen poultry usually is thawed before cooking, but poultry parts or whole poultry frozen without giblets can be cooked without thawing. Cooking time will be longer than for unfrozen poultry. Do not thaw commercially frozen stuffed poultry before cooking.

To thaw poultry in the refrigerator, place frozen poultry on a tray or shallow pan to catch the thawing drip; if unwrapped, cover lightly. Remove giblets from cavity when bird is pliable.

If it is not practical to thaw poultry in the refrigerator, immerse poultry in a watertight wrapper in cold water. Change water often to hasten thawing. Or you can partially thaw poultry in the refrigerator and partially in cold water. It takes 1 to 8 hours to thaw poultry in cold water, or 1 to 3 days in a refrigerator.

Cook poultry promptly after thawing. Stuff poultry just before roasting.

Cooking guides

Most poultry sold whole can be roasted. Stewing chickens and mature turkeys, however, are more tender if braised or stewed. They are good for stews, or to provide cooked meat for casseroles, sandwiches, and salads.

Broiler or fryer chickens can be roasted, ovenbaked, barbecued, or cooked on a rotisserie as well as broiled or fried. Fryer-roaster turkeys weighing 4 or 5 pounds can be roasted whole, or can be cut into parts and fried or broiled.

Rock Cornish game hens can be cooked like broiler or fryer chickens. Small ducks are suitable for broiling or frying; larger ones, for roasting or rotisserie cooking. Geese roast very well.

Roast poultry uncovered for best color and to reduce splitting and shrinkage. Poultry can be roasted with or without stuffing; unstuffed birds take slightly less time to cook. Cook poultry until tender and juicy; do not overcook.

Roasting

Prepare the poultry as directed above. Stuff the body and neck cavities lightly; allow about ½ cup of stuffing per pound of ready-to-cook poultry. See stuffing recipe (p. [28](#)). Or if desired, leave poultry unstuffed.

Fold loose neck skin toward back; fasten with a skewer. Turn wingtips back of heavy wingbone to rest against neck skin. Tuck ends of legs under band of skin at tail or fasten legs together close to body.

To roast poultry, place breast side up on a rack in a shallow pan. Do not cover pan and do not add water.

See roasting guide (p. [28](#)) for approximate times for roasting poultry.

A meat thermometer is the best guide to doneness of turkeys. Insert the thermometer into the center of the inner thigh muscle. Make sure it does not touch the bone.

Salt the giblets and neck, seal them in aluminum foil, and roast along with the poultry. Or simmer them in salted water until tender.

You can baste poultry with pan drippings or a little fat if you like.

If poultry browns early in the roasting period, cover the breast and drumsticks lightly with aluminum foil or with a thin cloth moistened with fat. After poultry is partly roasted, cut band of skin that holds legs together.

Use any one or more of the following ways to tell if poultry is done:

- A meat thermometer inserted in the center of the inner thigh muscle of a turkey reaches 180° to 185° F. If turkey is stuffed, also check stuffing temperature by inserting a thermometer into the body cavity for 5 minutes. Temperature should reach 165° F.

- Drumstick feels soft when you press meaty part with protected fingers.
- Drumstick moves up and down easily and leg joint gives readily.

CAUTION: Do not partly roast poultry on one day and complete roasting the following day.

ROASTING GUIDE

Kind of poultry	Ready-to-cook weight ^[10]	Approximate roasting time at 325° F. for stuffed poultry ^[11]	Internal temperature of poultry when done
	<i>Pounds</i>	<i>Hours</i>	°F.
Chickens (Broilers, fryers, or roasters)	1½ to 2½ 2½ to 4½	1 to 2 2 to 3½	
Ducks	4 to 6	2 to 3	
Geese	6 to 8 8 to 12	3 to 3½ 3½ to 4½	
Turkeys	6 to 8 8 to 12 12 to 16 16 to 20 20 to 24	3 to 3½ 3½ to 4½ 4½ to 5½ 5½ to 6½ 6½ to 7	180 to 185 in center of inner thigh muscle.

FOOTNOTES:

^[10] Weight of giblets and neck included.

[11] Unstuffed poultry may take slightly less time than stuffed poultry. Cooking time is based on chilled poultry or poultry that has just been thawed—temperature not above 40° F. Frozen unstuffed poultry will take longer. Do not use this roasting guide for frozen commercially stuffed poultry; follow package directions.

Stuffing

About 1 quart

3 tablespoons butter, margarine, or poultry fat

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup chopped celery

3 tablespoons chopped parsley

2 tablespoons chopped onion

1 quart soft breadcrumbs

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon savory seasoning

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt

Pepper, as desired

Melt fat in heavy pan; add celery, parsley, and onion, and cook a few minutes.

Combine all ingredients. Mix lightly but well.

Use to stuff poultry, or bake in a separate pan during the last hour of cooking.

NOTE: Allow about $\frac{1}{2}$ cup stuffing per pound of ready-to-cook poultry. This stuffing may be used for baked fish, if desired.

Variation

Nut stuffing.—Omit parsley and savory seasoning and add $\frac{1}{2}$ cup of chopped nutmeats—roasted almonds, pecans, filberts, or cooked chestnuts.

Braised boneless turkey roast

Place boneless turkey roast on a rack in a pan; insert a meat thermometer in the center of the roast; cover pan tightly. Braise in an oven at 400° F. (hot) until thermometer registers about 170° F. Or, follow cooking directions on package.

NOTE: A 3-pound boneless turkey roast requires about 1½ hours cooking time. If desired, uncover roast last 20 minutes to brown.

Broiled chicken

Plump young chicken, about 1½ to 2¼ pounds ready to cook

Melted fat or oil

Salt and pepper, as desired

Prepare chicken for cooking according to directions on page [26](#).

Split chicken down the back and, if desired, cut into halves through the breastbone. Break joints and cut off wingtips.

Brush chicken on both sides with melted fat and sprinkle with salt and pepper.

Preheat the broiler and grease broiler rack lightly. Place chicken on the rack, skin side down. Place broiler pan at the distance from heat recommended by the range manufacturer.

Broil chicken 20 to 30 minutes on one side or until browned; turn, brush with fat or oil, and broil until done, 15 to 25 minutes longer.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broccoli, creamed potatoes, and lemon chiffon pie.

Stewed chicken

Use a plump stewing chicken, 3 to 4 pounds ready to cook. Or, you can stew a broiler-fryer chicken, although the flavor will be somewhat milder.

Prepare chicken for cooking according to the directions on page 26. Leave whole or cut in serving-size pieces.

Place the chicken in a deep pan. Add enough water to half cover a whole chicken or to cover pieces. Season as desired.

Cover pan and cook over low heat until the chicken is tender—2 to 3 hours for a stewing chicken, 45 minutes to 1 hour for a broiler-fryer.

Cook giblets with the chicken or separately.

Serve stewed chicken in gravy made by thickening the broth, or use in any recipe that calls for cooked chicken.

Fried chicken

Plump young chicken, 1½ to 3 pounds ready to cook

Salt, pepper, flour

Fat or oil

Prepare chicken for cooking according to the directions on page [26](#). Cut in serving pieces.

Season chicken with salt and pepper and roll in flour.

In a heavy frypan, heat ¼ to ¾ cup fat or oil—just enough to cover bottom of pan. Use moderate heat.

Brown chicken pieces on one side; turn and brown on other side.

Continue to cook slowly, uncovered, until tender. Or, if more convenient, cook in oven at 350° F. (moderate) until tender. Cooking time will be from 30 to 45 minutes.

Variation

Oven-fried chicken.—Prepare the chicken according to directions on page [26](#). Cut in serving pieces. Preheat oven to 400° F. (hot). Shake or roll chicken pieces in seasoned flour and place in a baking pan containing hot fat (⅛ inch deep or less). Turn pieces to coat both sides with fat. Cook chicken skin side down for 30 minutes; turn; and cook 20 to 30 minutes longer, or until tender.

Menu suggestion

Serve with mashed potatoes, carrots, and green salad. For dessert have cherry pie.

Chicken a la king

6 servings

1 cup frozen green peas
2 tablespoons finely chopped onion
¼ cup chopped green pepper
⅓ cup boiling water
⅔ cup flour
1 cup cold milk
2 cups chicken broth
2 teaspoons salt
Pepper, as desired
½ teaspoon poultry seasoning
2 cups diced cooked chicken or turkey
1 can (4 ounces) mushroom stems and pieces, drained and chopped
1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
Cooked rice, toast, or biscuits

Cook peas, onion, and green pepper in boiling water in a covered pan 5 minutes. Drain; save the liquid.

Blend flour with milk. Combine vegetable cooking liquid, broth, and seasonings; slowly stir in flour mixture. Bring to a boil, stirring constantly; cook 1 minute.

Add chicken, cooked vegetables, mushrooms, and pimiento. Heat thoroughly and serve on rice, toast, or biscuits.

NOTE: Two chicken bouillon cubes and 2 cups of hot water may be used to make broth. Decrease salt to 1 teaspoon.

Menu suggestion

Serve with green beans, molded pineapple and carrot salad, and apple crisp.

Turkey-noodle bake

6 servings

4-ounce package noodles (about 2 cups uncooked)
¼ cup flour
2 cups mushroom liquid and water
2 chicken bouillon cubes

¼ teaspoon salt
Pepper, as desired
½ teaspoon poultry seasoning
1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
4-ounce can mushroom stems and pieces, drained, chopped
2 cups cooked turkey, cubed
¾ cup shredded sharp process cheese
⅓ cup fine dry breadcrumbs
1 tablespoon butter or margarine

Cook noodles as directed on package; drain.

In a saucepan, blend flour with a little of the liquid to make a paste. Gradually stir in remaining liquid. Add bouillon cubes and seasonings.

Bring to a boil, stirring constantly. Reduce heat to simmer; cook 1 minute longer, stirring as needed.

Add pimiento and mushrooms to sauce.

In a 2-quart casserole place half the noodles and half the turkey in layers. Cover with half the sauce. Repeat layers.

Top with cheese; sprinkle with breadcrumbs; dot with fat.

Bake, uncovered, at 350° F. (moderate oven) 30 to 40 minutes or until bubbly and browned.

Variation

Chicken-noodle bake.—Use chicken instead of turkey, and chicken broth instead of water and bouillon cubes.

Menu suggestion

Serve with buttered beets, coleslaw, and have ice cream for dessert.

Chicken pie

6 servings, 9- or 10-inch pie

Filling

3 tablespoons chicken fat, butter, or margarine
¼ cup flour
1¼ cups chicken broth
1 cup milk
1½ teaspoons salt
⅛ teaspoon pepper
¼ teaspoon poultry seasoning, if desired
2 cups cooked chicken, diced
1⅔ cups cooked peas and carrots

Pastry for top crust

1 cup flour
¾ teaspoon baking powder
½ teaspoon salt
⅓ cup shortening
2½ to 3 tablespoons water

Melt fat for the filling in a saucepan; blend in flour. Add broth, milk, and seasonings. Cook, stirring constantly, until thickened.

Add chicken and vegetables; heat thoroughly.

For the pastry, mix flour, with baking powder and salt.

Mix in fat until mixture is crumbly. Add a little water at a time, blending lightly.

Dough should be just moist enough to cling together when pressed into a ball.

Roll dough on a lightly floured surface; shape to fit top of 9- or 10-inch piepan. Make a few small slits near center.

Pour filling into piepan; top with pastry. Turn under pastry edges and press firmly to pan.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 30 minutes, or until browned.

Variation

Turkey pie.—Use turkey broth and cooked turkey in place of chicken broth and cooked chicken.

Menu suggestion

Serve with sliced tomatoes and celery strips and have spicy fruit for dessert.

Braised chicken with vegetables

6 servings

½ cup flour

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

3-pound ready-to-cook broiler-fryer chicken, cut up

3 tablespoons fat or oil

¾ cup hot water

½ teaspoon salt

1½ cups sliced carrots

3 cups sliced celery

¾ cup finely chopped onion

¾ cup chopped green pepper

Combine flour, 1 teaspoon salt, and pepper; coat chicken pieces with mixture. Brown chicken in hot fat in large frypan. Drain excess fat from pan. Add water and ½ teaspoon salt. Cover tightly and simmer 45 minutes to 1 hour, or until chicken is almost tender.

Add vegetables and cook 20 to 30 minutes longer, or until vegetables are tender.

Menu suggestion

Serve with rice, lettuce and tomato salad, and fruit for dessert.

Homemade noodles with chicken

6 servings

1 cup flour

1 egg or ¼ cup egg yolks (3 or 4 yolks), slightly beaten

1 tablespoon half-and-half or table cream

1½ teaspoons salt

¾ teaspoon poultry seasoning
Pepper, as desired
5 cups chicken broth
3 cups cubed cooked chicken (p. [29](#))
Paprika
Parsley

Combine first three ingredients thoroughly and form into a ball. Do not knead. Divide into two parts. Roll each part on lightly floured surface until paper thin. Allow dough to dry 5 to 10 minutes.

With a thin sharp knife, cut dough into strips of desired width and length.

Add seasonings to broth; bring to a boil. Add noodles and boil 9 to 12 minutes, or until tender. Add chicken and continue cooking only until chicken is hot. Sprinkle with paprika and garnish with parsley.

NOTE: One chicken bouillon cube and 1 cup of water may be used for each cup of broth; decrease salt to taste.

Timesaver

Use 1½ cups uncooked packaged noodles instead of making noodles.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broccoli, tossed vegetable salad, and brownies.

Fish

Fish may be cooked by any of the basic methods with excellent results. Fish should not be overcooked; cook only until it flakes easily when tested with a fork. This will leave the fish moist and tender and will bring out its flavor.

Pan-fried fish fillets or steaks

6 servings

2 pounds fish fillets or steaks, fresh or frozen
¼ cup milk
1 egg, beaten

1 teaspoon salt
Pepper, as desired
1½ cups fine dry bread, cereal, or cracker crumbs
Fat or oil

Thaw frozen fish. Cut fish into 6 portions.

Combine milk, egg, salt, and pepper. Dip fish in milk mixture and roll in crumbs.

Place fish in a single layer in hot fat in a 10-inch frypan. Fry over moderate heat 4 to 5 minutes, or until brown. Turn carefully. Fry 4 to 5 minutes longer, or until fish are brown and flake easily when tested with a fork. Drain on absorbent paper.

Variation

Deep-fat fried fish fillets or steaks.—Prepare fish as for pan-fried fish. Fill fry kettle one-third full of fat; heat to 350° F.

Place fish in a single layer in a fry basket. Fry 3 to 5 minutes, or until fish are brown and flake easily when tested with a fork. Drain on absorbent paper.

Menu suggestion

Serve with tartar sauce, baked potatoes, snap beans, tossed green salad, and upside-down cake.

TIMETABLE FOR COOKING FISH

Cooking method and market form	Approximate ready-to-cook weight or thickness	Cooking temperature	Approximate cooking time in minutes
BAKING			
Dressed	3 pounds	350° F.	45 to 60
Pan-dressed	3 pounds	350° F.	25 to 30
Fillets or steaks	2 pounds	350° F.	20 to 25
Portions	2 pounds	400° F.	15 to 20

Sticks	2¼ pounds	400° F.	15 to 20
BROILING			
Pan-dressed	3 pounds		10 to 16 ^[12]
Fillets or steaks	½ to 1 inch		10 to 15
Portions	¾ to ½ inch		10 to 15
Sticks	¾ to ½ inch		10 to 15
CHARCOAL BROILING			
Pan-dressed	3 pounds	Moderate	10 to 16 ^[12]
Fillets or steaks	½ to 1 inch	Moderate	10 to 16 ^[12]
Portions	¾ to ½ inch	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]
Sticks	¾ to ½ inch	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]
DEEP-FAT FRYING			
Pan-dressed	3 pounds	350° F.	3 to 5
Fillets or steaks	½ to 1 inch	350° F.	3 to 5
Portions	¾ to ½ inch	350° F.	3 to 5
Sticks	¾ to ½ inch	350° F.	3 to 5
OVEN-FRYING			
Pan-dressed	3 pounds	500° F.	15 to 20
Fillets or steaks	½ to 1 inch	500° F.	10 to 15
PAN-FRYING			
Pan-dressed	3 pounds	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]
Fillets or steaks	½ to 1 inch	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]

Portions	$\frac{3}{8}$ to $\frac{1}{2}$ inch	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]
Sticks	$\frac{3}{8}$ to $\frac{1}{2}$ inch	Moderate	8 to 10 ^[12]
POACHING			
Fillets or steaks	2 pounds	Simmer	5 to 10
STEAMING			
Fillets or steaks	2 pounds	Boil	5 to 10

FOOTNOTES:

^[12] Turn once.

Salmon loaf

6 servings

1 can (1 pound) salmon
 $\frac{1}{2}$ cup milk
 3 cups soft breadcrumbs
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup butter or margarine, melted
 $\frac{1}{3}$ cup salmon liquid
 3 egg yolks, beaten
 2 tablespoons finely chopped green pepper
 2 tablespoons finely chopped onion
 1 tablespoon lemon juice
 $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon pepper
 3 egg whites, stiffly beaten

Drain salmon; save the liquid. Flake salmon.

Heat milk. Add breadcrumbs and butter or margarine and let stand 5 minutes. Add salmon liquid and beat until smooth. Add egg yolks, green

pepper, onion, lemon juice, pepper, and salmon; mix well. Fold in egg whites. Pour into a well-greased 1½-quart loafpan.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 40 to 50 minutes, or until firm in center. Remove from oven and let stand 5 minutes. Loosen from sides of pan with a spatula and invert on a serving platter. Serve plain or with a sauce.

Menu suggestion

Serve with onion or pea sauce, scalloped potatoes, lettuce salad, and apple crisp.

Broiled pan-dressed fish

6 servings

3 pounds pan-dressed fish, fresh or frozen

¼ cup melted fat or oil

¼ cup lemon juice

1½ teaspoons salt

¾ teaspoon paprika

Pepper, as desired

Thaw frozen fish. Clean, wash, and dry fish.

Combine fat and seasonings. Place fish on well-greased broiler pan. Brush fish inside and out with seasoned fat.

Broil about 4 inches from heat 5 to 8 minutes. Turn fish carefully and brush on remaining fat. Broil 5 to 8 minutes longer, or until fish flake easily when tested with a fork.

Menu suggestion

Serve with fried potatoes, spinach, grapefruit salad, and gingerbread.

Baked fish fillets or steaks

6 servings

2 pounds fish fillets or steaks, fresh or frozen

2 tablespoons melted fat or oil

2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 teaspoon salt
½ teaspoon paprika
Pepper, as desired

Thaw frozen fish. Cut into 6 portions.

Place fish in a single layer, skin side down, in a well-greased baking dish. Combine remaining ingredients and pour over fish.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 20 to 25 minutes, or until fish flake easily when tested with a fork.

Menu suggestion

Serve with french-fried potatoes, cabbage, molded vegetable salad, and lemon chiffon pie.

Oven-fried fish fillets or steaks

6 servings

2 pounds fish fillets or steaks, fresh or frozen
½ cup milk
1 teaspoon salt
1½ cups cereal crumbs or toasted fine dry bread crumbs
¼ cup melted fat or oil

Thaw frozen fish. Cut into 6 portions.

Combine milk and salt. Dip fish in milk and roll in crumbs. Place fish in a single layer, skin side down, on a well-greased baking pan. Pour fat over fish.

Bake at 500° F. (extremely hot oven) 10 to 15 minutes, or until fish are brown and flake easily when tested with a fork.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broccoli, potatoes with cheese sauce, lettuce salad, and peach crisp.

Baked stuffed fish

6 servings

1 dressed fish (3 pounds), fresh or frozen
Salt and pepper, as desired
3 cups stuffing (p. [28](#))
2 tablespoons melted fat or oil

Thaw frozen fish. Clean, wash, and dry fish.

Sprinkle inside with salt and pepper. Place fish on a well-greased 18- by 13-inch bake-and-serve platter. Stuff fish loosely. Brush fish with fat.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 45 to 60 minutes, or until the fish flakes easily when tested with a fork.

NOTE: Fish may be baked without stuffing.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broiled tomatoes, peas and celery, coleslaw, and fruit pie.

Topsy turvy tuna pie

6 servings

1 can (6½ or 7 ounces) tuna
2 tablespoons chopped onion
1 tablespoon tuna oil
1 can (10½ ounces) condensed cream of mushroom soup
2 eggs, beaten
½ cup soft breadcrumbs
6 thin slices lemon or orange
1 package (12 ounces) cornbread or corn muffin mix

Drain tuna; save oil. Flake tuna.

Cook onion in oil until tender. Add soup, eggs, breadcrumbs, and tuna; mix well. Arrange lemon or orange slices on the bottom of a well-greased 10-inch piepan. Pour tuna mixture over fruit slices.

Prepare cornbread mix as directed on package. Spread batter over tuna mixture.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 25 to 30 minutes, or until brown. Remove from oven and let stand 5 minutes. Loosen from sides of pan with a spatula and invert on a serving plate.

Menu suggestion

Serve with stewed okra and tomatoes, celery sticks, brownies, and fruit.

Sardine puff

6 servings

2 cans (3¾ or 4 ounces each) Maine sardines
8 slices white bread
1½ tablespoons butter or margarine
¼ cup chopped green pepper
¾ cup shredded sharp natural Cheddar cheese
3 eggs
½ teaspoon salt
¼ teaspoon dry mustard
Pepper, as desired
2 cups milk
Paprika

Drain sardines and cut into thirds.

Remove crusts from bread, spread with butter or margarine, and cut bread into ½-inch cubes. Place half the bread cubes in a well-greased 12- by 8- by 2-inch baking dish. Cover with sardines, green pepper, and half the cheese. Top with remaining bread cubes and cheese.

Beat eggs, salt, mustard, and pepper. Add milk and mix well. Pour over bread and sprinkle with paprika.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 45 to 50 minutes, or until firm in the center. Remove from oven and let stand 5 minutes before serving.

Menu suggestion

Serve with green peas, a relish plate, and orange bavarian cream.

Eggs, cheese, dry beans

Main dishes made with eggs, cheese, or dry beans are economical choices for family meals.

Cooking eggs

For best eating quality, eggs should be cooked with low to moderate heat, for just the right amount of time. If cooking temperature is too high or the egg is cooked too long, the white becomes tough and the yolk mealy.

Caution on Use of Cracked or Soiled Eggs

Cracked or soiled eggs may contain bacteria that can produce food poisoning. For your protection, use cracked or soiled eggs only when they are thoroughly cooked or when the foods in which they are an ingredient are thoroughly cooked.

In this publication, a warning note is given with each recipe in which cracked or soiled eggs should not be used.

Scrambled eggs

Break eggs into a bowl. Add milk as follows: For creamy scrambled eggs, add 1 tablespoon milk for each egg; for dry scrambled eggs, add ½ tablespoon milk for each egg. For a product with uniform yellow color, beat mixture enough to blend yolks and whites thoroughly. If you prefer scrambled eggs with flecks of yellow and white, beat only slightly. Season with salt and pepper.

Pour the mixture into a heated frypan in which a little fat has been melted. Cook slowly, stirring occasionally to let the uncooked portion flow to the bottom. Cook until the mixture is set, but still moist.

Or, if preferred, use a double boiler. Melt a little fat in the top part, pour in the egg mixture, place over simmering water in the bottom of the boiler, and cook as above.

NOTE: Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.

Variation

Before cooking the mixture, add herbs, chopped onion, shredded cheese, or small pieces of cooked bacon or ham.

Eggs cooked in shell

Put eggs in a pan; cover them completely with cold water.

For soft-cooked eggs, heat water slowly to simmering. Cover pan and remove from heat. Let stand 3 to 5 minutes; allow the longer time for a larger number of eggs or for a firmer consistency.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

For hard-cooked eggs, bring water to simmering and simmer 20 to 25 minutes. Do not let the water boil. Serve the eggs hot or plunge them at once into cold running water and leave until cold.

NOTE: The green discoloration that sometimes appears between the white and the yolk of a hard-cooked egg results from a chemical reaction, which is harmless. To help prevent this discoloration, cook eggs at low temperature, avoid overcooking, and cool promptly.

Fried eggs

Heat a small amount of fat in a frypan. Bacon or ham drippings may be used for flavor. Break eggs, one at a time, into a saucer, and slip them into the fat. Sprinkle with salt and pepper. Cook over low heat, basting with the fat, until whites are firm.

Or, if you prefer eggs with less fat, use this “fry-poach” method. Melt a little fat in a frypan over low heat—just enough to grease the bottom. Add eggs one at a time, pour in 2 or 3 tablespoons of water, cover pan tightly, and steam until eggs are done. Season before serving.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

French toast

6 servings

4 eggs, beaten
2/3 cup milk
1/4 teaspoon salt
12 slices white bread
2 tablespoons fat or oil

Combine eggs, milk, and salt. Dip each side of bread in egg mixture.

Brown on both sides in fat on a hot griddle—3 to 4 minutes on each side. Serve immediately.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Variation

Add 1/2 teaspoon cinnamon or nutmeg to egg mixture before dipping bread.

Plain or french omelet

6 servings

6 eggs
3/4 teaspoon salt
Pepper, as desired
6 tablespoons milk
3 tablespoons butter or margarine

Beat eggs until yolks and whites are well mixed.

Add salt, pepper, and milk.

Melt the fat in a large frypan and pour in the egg mixture.

Cook over moderate heat. As the omelet cooks, lift edges toward center and tip pan so that the uncooked mixture flows under the cooked portion. Continue cooking until bottom is light brown.

Fold one half of the omelet over the other half and serve at once.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Variations

Spread tart jelly or browned mushrooms on half the omelet just before folding.

Sprinkle top of the omelet with shredded cheese, your favorite herbs, or bits of crisp bacon or ham.

Poached eggs

Break eggs into a saucer or custard cup, one at a time, then slip them into gently boiling, salted water—enough water to cover the eggs in a shallow pan.

Reheat water to simmering, take pan from heat, cover. Let stand 5 minutes, or until eggs are of desired firmness. Remove eggs from water and sprinkle with salt and pepper.

NOTE: Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.

Poached eggs supreme

6 servings

1 can (10½ ounces) condensed Cheddar cheese soup

2 tablespoons chopped green pepper

¼ cup process sharp Cheddar cheese spread

6 slices toast

6 eggs

Combine soup and green pepper; heat. Spread cheese on toast. Poach eggs until firm (p. [38](#)). Place eggs on toast and cover with hot soup mixture. Serve immediately.

NOTE: Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.

Menu suggestion

Serve with green beans, fruit salad, and oatmeal cookies.

Deviled eggs

6 servings

6 eggs
¼ cup mayonnaise
1 teaspoon prepared mustard
½ teaspoon vinegar
¼ teaspoon salt
White pepper, as desired
Paprika

Hard-cook eggs as directed on page [37](#). Cool eggs under cold running water 5 to 10 minutes. Peel shells from eggs. Cut eggs in half lengthwise. Mash yolks with remaining ingredients except paprika until mixture is smooth. Fill whites with this mixture; sprinkle with paprika.

Variation

Ham-deviled eggs.—Omit salt. Add 1 can (2¼ ounces) deviled ham to yolk mixture.

Baked eggs in hash nests

6 servings

1 can (1 pound, 8 ounces) corned beef hash
6 eggs
2 tablespoons fine dry breadcrumbs, if desired
Salt and pepper, as desired
1 tablespoon butter or margarine

Spread hash evenly in a 10½- by 7- by 2-inch baking pan. Form six depressions by pressing the bottom of a ½-cup measure into the hash.

Break an egg into each depression. Sprinkle each egg with breadcrumbs, if desired. Sprinkle with salt and pepper; dot with fat.

Bake at 325° F. (slow oven) 20 to 25 minutes, or until eggs are as firm as desired.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Menu suggestion

Serve with mixed vegetables, lettuce wedges, and brownies.

Cooking cheese

Cheese, like eggs, should be cooked at low temperatures and never overcooked.

Melt cheese over simmering water, or add it to a hot mixture. Add cheese to a sauce after the sauce is cooked and heat only long enough to melt the cheese. Add cheese to an omelet just before folding.

Bake casseroles containing cheese at low to moderate temperatures. To keep cheese toppings from toughening or hardening, cover the cheese with crumbs or add cheese just a few minutes before the casserole comes out of the oven.

Cheese blends more readily with other ingredients and melts more quickly if you shred or dice it first.

Spanish rice with cheese

6 servings

3 slices bacon

1 small onion, finely chopped

¼ cup chopped green pepper

¼ cup chopped celery

1 cup water

½ teaspoon salt

¾ cup packaged precooked rice

2 cups cooked or canned tomatoes

1 teaspoon sugar

¼ teaspoon worcestershire sauce

1 cup shredded Cheddar cheese

Fry bacon in a heavy 2-quart saucepan. Drain bacon on paper. In 1 tablespoon bacon drippings, lightly brown onion, green pepper, and celery.

Add water and salt; bring to a boil. Stir in rice, tomatoes, sugar, and worcestershire sauce. Simmer until rice is just tender, stirring occasionally.

Crumble bacon and stir into rice mixture. Sprinkle cheese over top. Cover and continue cooking over very low heat until cheese is melted,

about 5 minutes.

Menu suggestion

Serve with kale, fruit salad, and ice cream.

Pizza

2 pizzas, 14 inches in diameter

1 yeast roll recipe (p. [59](#))

4 cups shredded cheese (Mozzarella, Muenster, Colby, or process Swiss or Cheddar)

2 cans (8 ounces each) Spanish-style tomato sauce

½ teaspoon oregano

½ cup grated Parmesan cheese

Preheat oven with oven regulator set at broil; leave oven door closed.

Prepare roll dough as directed in recipe, but do not allow to rise. Divide dough into two equal portions; form each into a ball. On a floured surface, roll out each ball of dough into a 14-inch circle. Place on lightly greased pizza pans or baking sheets, turning up edges of dough slightly to form rim.

Sprinkle each pizza with 2 cups shredded cheese. Combine tomato sauce and oregano; spread half the mixture over each pizza. Sprinkle half the Parmesan cheese over each pizza.

Place pizzas in preheated oven and turn oven regulator to 525° F. (extremely hot). Bake 20 to 25 minutes, or until crust is crisp.

NOTE: Any of toppings below may be added before Parmesan cheese. Amounts are for 1 pizza:

1 can (8 ounces) sliced mushrooms, drained

¾ pound ground beef, browned and drained

¼ pound pepperoni, thinly sliced

¾ pound fresh pork sausage, browned and drained

Menu suggestion

Serve with mixed vegetable salad and fruit for dessert.

Macaroni with cheese sauce

6 servings

¼ cup butter or margarine

¼ cup flour

½ teaspoon salt

2 cups milk

½ teaspoon mustard

1½ cups cut-up processed Cheddar cheese

3 cups cooked macaroni

Melt fat and mix in flour and salt. Add milk slowly, stirring constantly, until sauce starts to boil. Lower heat and cook 3 minutes, or until thick.

Add mustard and cheese. Stir over low heat until cheese softens.

Mix in cooked macaroni and heat through.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broiled tomatoes, asparagus, lettuce, and apple crisp.

Baked cheese fondue

6 servings

12 slices white bread

¾ pound process Cheddar cheese, thinly sliced

3 eggs, beaten

3 cups milk

½ teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

Sage, as desired

1 tablespoon butter or margarine

Grease an 8- by 12- by 2-inch baking dish. Trim crusts from bread. Lay 6 slices in dish; cover with cheese. Top with remaining bread. Combine eggs and milk. Add seasonings and pour over bread. Dot with fat.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 45 minutes to 1 hour, or until set.

Variation

Place a layer of $\frac{3}{4}$ cup ground cooked ham on top of cheese before topping with bread.

Menu suggestion

Serve with peas, coleslaw, and apple pie.

Cooking dry beans

Dry beans need soaking before cooking. Use $2\frac{1}{2}$ cups water for 1 cup of blackeye beans (blackeye peas, cowpeas), Great Northern beans, and lima beans. Use 3 cups water for 1 cup of kidney beans, pea (navy) beans, and pinto beans.

To soak them quickly, boil beans 2 minutes, remove from heat, and let stand 1 hour. Or if you prefer, boil beans 2 minutes and let them stand overnight.

Cook the beans in the soaking water. Add 1 teaspoon salt for 1 cup of beans; boil gently for the time given below. One cup of uncooked beans yields about $2\frac{1}{2}$ cups cooked beans.

<i>Kind of beans</i>	<i>Approximate cooking time (hours)</i>
Blackeye (blackeye peas, cowpeas).	$\frac{1}{2}$
Great Northern	1 to $1\frac{1}{2}$
Kidney	2
Lima	1
Pea (navy)	$1\frac{1}{2}$ to 2
Pinto	2

Dry beans will cook more quickly if you add baking soda to the water before soaking. If tap water is of medium hardness, adding $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon soda to the water for each cup of dry beans reduces cooking time about one-fourth. Measure soda exactly; too much soda affects flavor and nutritive value of beans.

To reduce foaming when cooking dry beans, add 1 tablespoon meat drippings or other fat to the cooking water for each cup of beans.

Cooked dry beans may be seasoned and eaten without further cooking, or they may be baked, or combined with other foods.

If acid ingredients like tomatoes, catsup, or vinegar are included in the recipe, add them after the beans are tender. Acids prevent softening of the beans.

Boston baked beans

6 servings

2 cups dry navy beans

6 cups (1½ quarts) water

¼ pound salt pork, cut in chunks or slices

1½ teaspoons salt

¼ cup brown sugar, packed

1 teaspoon dry mustard

2 teaspoons chopped onion

½ cup dark molasses

Boil beans in water 2 minutes. Soak 1 hour, or overnight if preferred.

Add salt pork and salt to beans and simmer until beans are tender, about 1½ hours. Drain; save ½ cup liquid. Place beans in a 3-quart casserole.

Combine bean cooking liquid, brown sugar, mustard, onion, and molasses. Pour over beans. Bake uncovered at 350° F. (moderate oven) 1 hour, or until beans are lightly browned on top and of desired consistency.

Menu suggestion

Serve with frankfurters or cold cuts, coleslaw, and baked apples.

Vegetables

Knowing how to prepare vegetables to retain their nutritive value and appetite appeal is a test of any good cook. To help you improve your skill with vegetables, here are some cooking tips—

- Boil vegetables in as little water as possible; losses in vitamins and minerals will be less, the less water you use. Serve the cooking liquids with your vegetables, or make them into sauces, gravies, or soups.
- Cook vegetables until just tender, and serve them immediately; they will taste better and retain more nutrients.
- Trim leafy vegetables like lettuce and cabbage sparingly. Use the dark outer leaves—they are especially rich in nutrients. Remove woody midribs from kale leaves—there is little nutritive loss and the kale cooks more uniformly.

Fresh vegetables

Preparing for cooking

Wash vegetables thoroughly. Use plenty of water for leafy greens; wash several times, lifting vegetables from the water.

Remove bruised, wilted, or tough parts; trim sparingly.

Soak fresh brussels sprouts and broccoli in cold salt water (2 teaspoons salt for each quart of water) 30 to 60 minutes to remove any insects.

Cooking times

In using the Boiling Guide for Fresh Vegetables on the following page, remember that vegetables may require shorter or longer cooking time than given, the exact time depending on quality and variety of vegetable. The altitude at which you live will also affect cooking times; you can shorten the time by cutting, slicing, dicing, or coarsely shredding vegetables.

Boiling fresh vegetables

Bring salted water to a boil. One-half to 1 cup water usually is enough for 6 servings of young, tender vegetables. Older root vegetables that need longer cooking may require water to cover. Spinach and other greens need only the water clinging to their leaves from washing if cooked over low heat in a pan with a tight-fitting lid. Tomatoes can be cooked in their own juice.

Add vegetable. Cover, and quickly bring water back to a boil. Reduce heat and cook gently until vegetable is just tender. Start timing after water returns to boiling.

Frozen and canned vegetables

Frozen.—Cook frozen vegetables according to package directions. For uniform cooking, thaw leafy vegetables just enough to separate the leaves before you put them in boiling water. Partly thaw corn on the cob before cooking it. If necessary, separate pieces of frozen vegetables with a fork during cooking.

Canned.—Commercially canned vegetables need reheating only. If liquid is not served with the vegetable, save it for other uses. (See Ways to Use Leftovers, p. [75](#).)

Unless you are absolutely sure home-canned vegetables have been processed correctly, bring them to a rolling boil. Then cover and boil for at least 10 minutes. Boil spinach and corn 20 minutes. If food looks spoiled, foams, or has an off-odor during heating, destroy it.

Serving boiled vegetables

Hot, seasoned.—Any vegetable or a combination of two or more.

Before cooking, add a pinch of an herb, such as marjoram or thyme. Or after cooking, season with butter, margarine, or drippings—or with salad oil and lemon juice, horseradish, or garlic. Or sprinkle cooked vegetables with herb vinegar or crumbled bacon.

Mashed.—Potatoes, sweetpotatoes, turnips, rutabagas, kohlrabi, carrots, winter squash.

Drain and mash cooked vegetable. Add hot milk or cream to moisten if needed. Season with salt, pepper, and butter or margarine. Beat until fluffy.

Creamed.—Peas, carrots, celery, cabbage, asparagus, broccoli, potatoes, snap beans, onions, lima beans, cauliflower, spinach.

For 6 servings, combine 3 cups drained cooked vegetable with 1½ cups medium white sauce (p. [57](#)); heat. You may prefer thin white sauce with potatoes or lima beans.

For quick creamed vegetables, pour 1 can (10½ ounces) undiluted condensed soup—Cheddar cheese or cream of celery or mushroom—over 3 cups drained cooked vegetable; heat.

BOILING GUIDE FOR FRESH VEGETABLES

<i>Vegetable</i>	<i>Boiling time (minutes)</i>
Asparagus:	
Whole	10 to 20
Tips	5 to 15
Beans:	
Lima	25 to 30
Snap, 1-inch pieces	12 to 16
Beets:	
Young, whole	30 to 45
Older, whole	45 to 90
Sliced or diced	15 to 25
Beet greens, young	5 to 15
Broccoli, heavy stalks, split	10 to 15
Brussels sprouts	15 to 20
Cabbage:	
Shredded	3 to 10
Quartered	10 to 15
Carrots:	
Young, whole	15 to 20
Older, whole	20 to 30

Sliced or diced	10 to 20
Cauliflower:	
Separated	8 to 15
Whole	15 to 25
Celery, cut up	15 to 18
Chard	10 to 20
Collards	10 to 20
Corn, on cob	5 to 15
Kale	10 to 15
Okra	10 to 15
Onions	15 to 30
Parsnips:	
Whole	20 to 40
Quartered	8 to 15
Peas	12 to 16
Potatoes:	
Whole, medium size	25 to 40
Quartered	20 to 25
Diced	10 to 15
Rutabagas, pared, cut up	20 to 30
Spinach	3 to 10
Squash:	
Summer, sliced	8 to 15
Winter, cut up	15 to 20
Sweetpotatoes, whole	35 to 55
Tomatoes, cut up	7 to 15
Turnips:	
Cut up	10 to 20
Whole	20 to 30
Turnip greens	10 to 30

Chilled, in salads.—Chill cooked vegetables and marinate them in sweet french or italian dressing. See recipes on page [53](#).

With a sauce.—Suggestions for vegetable and sauce combinations follow. Sauce recipes begin on page [57](#).

- Asparagus—mock hollandaise sauce, lemon-butter sauce, egg sauce.
- Green beans—quick mushroom or celery sauce.
- Broccoli—sour cream sauce, lemon-butter sauce, mock hollandaise sauce.
- Cauliflower—lemon-butter sauce, cheese sauce.
- Peas—onion sauce, quick mushroom or celery sauce.
- Potatoes—sour cream sauce, cheese sauce.
- Spinach—lemon-butter sauce, mock hollandaise sauce, egg sauce.
- Sweetpotatoes—honey-orange sauce.

Panned vegetables

Panning is a good way to cook cabbage, carrots, or corn.

For 6 servings, use 1½ quarts finely shredded cabbage or 1 quart cut corn or thinly sliced carrots.

Heat 1½ to 2 tablespoons butter, margarine, meat drippings, or oil in a heavy pan over moderate heat. Add vegetable and sprinkle with ½ teaspoon salt. Add 3 tablespoons water (6 tablespoons for corn) and cover pan tightly to hold in steam.

Cook over low heat until vegetable is tender; stir occasionally to prevent sticking. Cabbage will require 6 to 8 minutes, carrots about 10 minutes, and corn 15 to 18 minutes.

Variation

Add finely chopped onion or onion juice before cooking. Or add bits of crumbled crisp bacon or diced ham to cooked vegetable.

Spinach souffle

6 servings

1 package (10 ounces) frozen chopped spinach
1 tablespoon finely chopped onion

¼ cup fat or oil
⅓ cup flour
1½ cups milk
1½ teaspoons salt
¼ teaspoon pepper
4 eggs, separated
½ teaspoon cream of tartar

Cook spinach as directed on package, but omit salt. Drain.

Lightly brown onion in fat in a heavy 1-quart saucepan. Blend in flour. Slowly stir in milk. Bring to a boil, stirring constantly. Reduce heat and cook 1 minute more, stirring constantly. Add salt, pepper, and spinach.

Beat egg yolks slightly; stir in a little of hot mixture. Then stir egg yolks into remaining hot mixture and cook 1 minute more. Cool slightly.

Add cream of tartar to egg whites and beat until stiff but not dry. Fold in spinach mixture. Pour into a greased 2-quart casserole. Set casserole in a pan of hot water.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) about 1¼ hours. Souffle is done when a knife inserted in the center comes out clean.

Broiled tomatoes

6 servings

3 large or 6 small ripe tomatoes
Salt and pepper, as desired
2 teaspoons butter or margarine
2 tablespoons fine dry breadcrumbs

Wash tomatoes; cut off stem ends. Cut large tomatoes in 1-inch slices; cut small tomatoes in half crosswise.

Place cut side up on broiler rack. Sprinkle with salt and pepper. Dot each slice with fat and sprinkle with breadcrumbs.

Broil until tomatoes are soft and crumbs lightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes.

Sweetpotatoes in orange shells

6 servings

3 oranges

1 can (1 pound) sweetpotatoes, undrained

2 tablespoons butter or margarine, melted

3 tablespoons brown sugar, packed

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup flaked coconut

6 miniature marshmallows

Squeeze oranges; save juice.

Remove membranes from orange shells.

Mash sweetpotatoes. Blend in 3 tablespoons orange juice, fat, brown sugar, and salt. Stir in coconut.

Spoon sweetpotato mixture into the orange shells. Place in a shallow baking pan.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) for 20 to 30 minutes, or until lightly browned on top.

Top with marshmallows and bake about 5 minutes longer to melt and brown marshmallows.

Hungarian cabbage

6 servings

2 slices bacon

2 quarts coarsely shredded cabbage (about 1 pound)

$\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon salt

Pepper, as desired

2 tablespoons vinegar

2 tablespoons water

Fry bacon until crisp; remove from pan. Add remaining ingredients to fat in pan.

Cover tightly and cook over low heat, stirring occasionally, for 20 to 25 minutes. Cabbage should be tender but crisp.

Crumble bacon over top before serving.

Stewed okra and tomatoes

6 servings

1 small onion, chopped
2 tablespoons fat or oil
1 package (10 ounces) frozen okra
1 can (1 pound) tomatoes
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt
 $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon pepper

Cook onion in fat in saucepan over moderate heat until lightly browned.

Add remaining ingredients and cook until okra is tender and mixture thickens, 10 to 15 minutes. Stir occasionally to prevent sticking.

Quick cauliflower au gratin

6 servings

2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen cauliflower
1 can (10 $\frac{1}{2}$ ounces) condensed Cheddar cheese soup
2 tablespoons fine dry breadcrumbs
1 teaspoon melted butter or margarine

Cook frozen cauliflower according to package directions.

Drain cauliflower and place in a greased 1-quart casserole. Pour undiluted soup over cauliflower. Mix crumbs with fat and sprinkle over top. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 20 to 30 minutes, or until sauce bubbles and crumbs are brown.

NOTE: Two pounds of fresh cauliflower, separated into small flowerets and cooked until tender, can be used instead of frozen cauliflower.

Variation

Quick spinach au gratin.—Use 2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen chopped spinach. Crumble 6 slices crisp fried bacon over mixture before topping with crumb mixture.

Lima bean creole

6 servings

2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen lima beans

6 slices bacon

¼ cup finely chopped onion

2 tablespoons chopped green pepper

½ teaspoon salt

Pepper, as desired

2 cups cooked or canned tomatoes

Cook beans as directed on package; drain.

Fry bacon; drain on absorbent paper. In 2 tablespoons bacon drippings, brown onion and green pepper. Crumble bacon. Add browned onion and green pepper, bacon, seasonings, and tomatoes to beans. Cover and simmer gently 15 minutes.

Variations

Green bean creole.—Use 2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen cut green beans instead of lima beans.

Eggplant creole.—Use 1 medium-size eggplant, pared and cubed, instead of beans. Do not cook eggplant before combining with other ingredients. Increase salt to 1 teaspoon. Cook 15 to 20 minutes, until eggplant is tender.

Scalloped zucchini squash

6 servings

6 cups thinly sliced zucchini squash

1 cup boiling water

¾ cup medium white sauce (p. [57](#))

2 eggs, beaten

1 teaspoon salt

½ teaspoon worcestershire sauce

1 teaspoon finely chopped onion

¼ cup fine dry breadcrumbs

1 tablespoon butter or margarine, melted

Cook squash in boiling water until tender, about 5 minutes. Drain.

Make white sauce.

Stir a little hot white sauce into beaten eggs; then gradually stir eggs into remaining sauce. Stir in salt, worcestershire sauce, onion, and cooked squash.

Put in a greased 1-quart casserole. Mix breadcrumbs with fat; sprinkle over squash mixture. Bake at 325° F. (slow oven) about 35 minutes.

Ham-seasoned green beans

6 servings

1½ pounds green beans, broken into short pieces

2 small onions, quartered

½ stalk celery, sliced

About 2 ounces cooked ham, cut into bite-sized pieces

2 teaspoons salt

Pepper, as desired

½ cup water

1 tablespoon butter or margarine

Place beans in a 2-quart saucepan. Add remaining ingredients. Simmer until beans are tender, 12 to 20 minutes.

NOTE: Instead of fresh green beans, use 2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen cut green beans.

Harvard beets

6 servings

3 tablespoons cornstarch

⅓ cup sugar

¾ teaspoon salt

1½ cups beet liquid (or beet liquid plus water)

2 tablespoons vinegar

1½ tablespoons butter or margarine

3 cups sliced cooked or canned beets

Mix cornstarch, sugar, and salt. Blend in beet liquid, vinegar, and fat. Cook over moderate heat, stirring constantly, until thickened.

Add beets to sauce. Let stand 10 minutes, if desired, to blend flavors. Heat to serving temperature.

Eggplant casserole

6 servings

2 cups pared, cubed eggplant
2 tablespoons finely chopped onion
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup water
2 eggs, slightly beaten
2 slices soft bread, torn in very small pieces
 $\frac{1}{2}$ cup milk
1 teaspoon salt
Pepper, as desired
 $1\frac{1}{4}$ cups shredded sharp Cheddar cheese

Cook eggplant and onion in unsalted water until eggplant is tender, about 7 minutes; drain. Combine all ingredients except $\frac{1}{4}$ cup cheese; mix well. Pour into a greased 1-quart casserole. Bake uncovered at 350° F. (moderate oven) 25 minutes. Sprinkle with remaining cheese and bake 5 minutes longer.

Glazed carrots

6 servings

2 tablespoons butter or margarine
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup brown sugar, packed
1 tablespoon water
3 cups cooked carrots, cut in strips

Blend fat, sugar, and water in a heavy fry pan over low heat. Add carrots. Cook over low heat 5 to 10 minutes, turning carrots to coat all sides with sirup. Keep heat low to prevent scorching.

Potato patties

6 patties

2 cups seasoned mashed potatoes
1 egg or 2 egg yolks, slightly beaten
1 tablespoon finely chopped onion
1 tablespoon chopped green pepper
2 tablespoons fat or oil

Combine all ingredients except fat; mix well. Shape into six patties. Brown well in hot fat, about 4 minutes on each side.

NOTE: Leftover mashed potatoes or instant mashed potatoes, prepared according to package directions, may be used in this recipe.

Stuffed baked potatoes

6 servings

6 medium-size baking potatoes
1 package (3 ounces) cream cheese, at room temperature
⅓ cup milk
1 teaspoon salt
⅓ cup butter or margarine
Paprika

Rub potatoes with a little fat if soft skins are desired. Bake at 425° F. (hot oven) 50 to 60 minutes, or until potato is soft when pressed. Slash tops lengthwise and crosswise. Fold back flaps, scoop out inside, and mash thoroughly.

Soften cream cheese and blend in milk, salt, and fat until smooth and creamy. Add cream cheese mixture gradually to hot potato, blending thoroughly.

Stuff skins with potato mixture. Sprinkle with paprika. Return to oven a few minutes to brown tops.

Green bean-mushroom casserole

6 servings

2 packages (10 ounces each) frozen cut green beans

¼ cup finely chopped onion

¼ cup water

1 teaspoon salt

1 can (10½ ounces) condensed cream of mushroom soup

1 can (4 ounces) mushroom stems and pieces, drained, chopped

½ cup canned french-fried onion rings

Cook beans and chopped onion in water with salt until beans are tender, 12 to 15 minutes. Drain.

Stir in undiluted soup and mushrooms. Pour into greased 1½-quart casserole. Top with onion rings. Cover and bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 30 minutes, or until mixture is heated through and top is brown.

Onions in mushroom sauce

6 servings

1½ pounds small yellow onions

1 cup water

1 teaspoon salt

1 can (10½ ounces) condensed cream of mushroom soup

Parsley

Peel and quarter onions. Leave very small onions whole. Simmer onions in salted water 15 to 20 minutes, or until just tender. Drain.

Add undiluted soup and simmer 10 to 15 minutes longer. Garnish with parsley before serving.

Salads and Salad Dressings

What better way to serve a variety of fruits, vegetables, even meats—than in a colorful salad? As an appetizer, a side dish, a dessert, or the main course of your meal, a salad brings lots of goodness to your table. Salads can be light or hearty, depending on the ingredients you choose.

Summertime salads often feature a medley of fresh fruits. Tossed green salads are year-round favorites. Salads made from eggs and potatoes, from seafoods, and from meats and cheeses also deserve a place in your meal planning.

Tips on salad making

Selecting top-quality fruits and vegetables is a good start toward a good salad. Fresh food has eye and taste appeal.

Give salad foods the best care to avoid damage and to keep them fresh. If you prepare salad ingredients ahead of time, store them, without dressing, in the refrigerator.

If you plan to use unpeeled fruits or vegetables in a salad, choose those with smooth, tender, colorful skins.

See page [12](#) for other pointers on selecting fresh fruits and vegetables. You'll find suggestions for storing them on page [14](#).

For appetite appeal

Chill ingredients before you mix your salad.

For tossed green salads, tear greens into fairly large pieces. This will give your salad more body.

Always thoroughly drain the greens you use in salads.

Vary your salad greens. Try chicory, escarole, endive, kale, spinach, dandelion greens, romaine, watercress, and chinese cabbage.

Some salad fruits are likely to turn dark on standing; dip these in a little citrus juice.

Drain canned fruits and vegetables before you add them to a salad.

Tips on dressings

Main-dish salads made with meat, fish, poultry, eggs, beans, cheese, or potatoes usually call for a mayonnaise-type dressing, but some are good with french or italian dressing (p. [53](#)).

On vegetable salads and vegetable-fruit combinations, try french, italian, thousand island, or Roquefort or blue cheese dressing (p. [53](#)). Fruit salads taste best with sweet dressings—sweet french, orange-honey, or celery seed dressing ([p. [53](#)]).

Prevent sogginess and wilting by using just enough salad dressing to moisten ingredients. Add dressing to raw vegetable salads at the last minute unless your recipe calls for marinated vegetables.

Salad go-togethers

Some salad combinations are traditional—lettuce and sliced tomatoes, canned peaches and cottage cheese. You can make a variety of salads by sometimes contrasting flavors and textures, sometimes complementing them.

Ingredients that go well together in salads are suggested below.

Fruit salad combinations

6 servings

- Pare and section 2 grapefruit and 3 oranges. For each salad arrange grapefruit and orange sections on a lettuce leaf; garnish with a maraschino cherry half.
- Lightly mix 1½ cups each of cantaloup, honeydew, and watermelon balls or cubes. Serve on crisp salad greens. Allow about ⅔ cup fruit per serving.

- Drain 1 can (13½ ounces) pineapple tidbits; combine with 3 oranges, pared and sectioned, and 1 banana, sliced. Place on crisp salad greens and sprinkle with ¼ cup chopped walnuts. Allow about ½ cup fruit per serving.

- Lightly mix 2 cups cantaloup cubes; ½ cup fresh blueberries; and 1 large banana, sliced. Serve on crisp salad greens; allow about ½ cup fruit per salad.

- Combine 4 peaches, peeled and sliced; ½ cup halved seedless grapes; ½ cup halved, seeded Tokay grapes; and 1 large banana, sliced. Serve on crisp salad greens; allow about ⅔ cup fruit per serving.

Vegetable salad combinations

6 servings

- Lightly toss together ½ pound young spinach leaves, torn in bite-size pieces; 2 green onions, thinly sliced; and 4 crisp bacon strips, crumbled. Garnish with 2 hard-cooked eggs, chopped.

- Lightly toss together 2 carrots, thinly sliced; ½ head raw cauliflower, thinly sliced; ½ head lettuce, torn in bite-size pieces; ¼ cup chopped green pepper; and 2 tomatoes, cut in wedges.

- Cook, drain, and chill 1 package (10 ounces) frozen mixed vegetables; lightly toss together with ½ head lettuce, torn in bite-size pieces.

Marinated vegetable salads

6 servings

Asparagus spear salad.—Hard cook 2 eggs; chill. Drain 1 can (1 pound) asparagus spears and marinate overnight in ½ cup sweet french dressing (p. [53](#)). For each salad arrange asparagus spears on a lettuce leaf, top with a strip of canned pimiento, and sprinkle with chopped hard-cooked egg.

Cucumber and onion salad.—Score 2 cucumbers with a fork; pare first, if desired. Slice thinly. Slice ½ medium onion and separate it into rings. Marinate cucumber and onion slices 3 to 4 hours in ½ cup sweet french dressing (p. [53](#)). Serve garnished with tomato wedges.

Green bean salad.—Drain 1 can (1 pound) cut green beans and 1 can (8 ounces) cut wax beans. Thinly slice 1 small onion and separate into rings. Toss beans and onion rings with $\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped sweet red or green pepper. Marinate overnight in $\frac{1}{2}$ cup sweet french dressing (p. [53](#)).

Three-bean salad.—Drain 8-ounce cans of green beans, wax beans, and kidney beans; continue as directed for green bean salad.

Creamy fruit salad

6 servings

1 package (3 ounces) cream cheese
1 tablespoon sirup from canned mandarin oranges
1 can (11 ounces) mandarin orange sections, drained
1 can (13½ ounces) pineapple tidbits, drained
1 cup miniature marshmallows
 $\frac{1}{3}$ cup halved, drained maraschino cherries
Lettuce

Beat cream cheese with liquid from mandarin oranges until creamy. Add oranges, pineapple, and marshmallows; combine gently but thoroughly. Lightly fold in cherries. Chill. Serve in lettuce cups.

Variation

Frozen fruit salad.—Blend $\frac{1}{4}$ cup mayonnaise with cream cheese and liquid before adding the fruits. Whip 1 envelope of dessert topping mix as directed on package label. Fold whipped topping and cherries into the fruit mixture. Pour into a 1½-quart mold and freeze overnight. Dip in warm water to unmold.

Molded pineapple-carrot salad

6 servings

1 package (3 ounces) lemon-flavored gelatin
1 cup shredded raw carrots
1 can (10½ ounces) crushed pineapple, drained
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup raisins

Lettuce

Mayonnaise

Prepare gelatin according to package directions, using pineapple sirup as part of the liquid. Chill until mixture is slightly thickened.

Fold in carrots, pineapple, and raisins; pour into a 1-quart mold. Chill until firm. Serve on lettuce; top with mayonnaise if desired.

Souffle meat salad

6 servings

1 package (3 ounces) lemon-flavored gelatin

1 cup boiling water

½ cup cold water

½ cup salad dressing

2 tablespoons vinegar

¼ teaspoon salt

Pepper, as desired

½ cup chopped celery

1 tablespoon chopped parsley

1 tablespoon grated onion

2 cups chopped cooked meat

Salad greens

Dissolve gelatin in boiling water. Add cold water, salad dressing, vinegar, salt, and pepper. Beat until smooth. Chill until slightly thickened.

Whip until fluffy. Fold in celery, parsley, onion, and meat. Pour into a 1-quart mold. Chill until firm.

Unmold on salad greens.

Variations

Souffle poultry salad.—Use 2 cups chopped cooked poultry as the meat.

Souffle fish salad.—Use 2 cups flaked canned or cooked fish as the meat.

Menu suggestion

Serve with broiled tomatoes, asparagus, and have apple pie with cheese for dessert.

Stuffed prune salad

6 servings

½ cup creamed cottage cheese
1 to 2 tablespoons milk, if needed
1 to 2 teaspoons grated orange rind, as desired
¼ cup chopped peanuts
¼ teaspoon salt (if peanuts are unsalted)
18 chilled, pitted, cooked prunes
Salad greens

If cottage cheese is dry, soften it with milk. Mix in orange rind, 3 tablespoons peanuts, and salt; stuff into prunes.

Arrange prunes on salad greens and sprinkle with rest of peanuts.

Luncheon chef salad bowl

6 main-dish salads

2 medium heads lettuce
8 radishes, thinly sliced
4 green onions, with tops, thinly sliced
3 large ripe tomatoes, cut into 8 wedges each
3 cups cooked ham (about 1 pound), cut into 1-inch cubes
2 cups coarsely shredded Swiss cheese
Croutons (p. [56](#))
Salad dressing

Wash and drain lettuce. Reserve outer lettuce leaves; tear remaining lettuce into bite-size pieces. Combine torn lettuce, radishes, and green onions; toss lightly.

Line 6 individual salad bowls with lettuce leaves. For each salad, use 2 cups lettuce mixture and top with 4 tomato wedges, ½ cup ham cubes, and

1/3 cup shredded cheese. Top with croutons. Serve with dressing of your choice.

Menu suggestion

Serve with garlic bread and have quick cherry cobbler for dessert.

Coleslaw

6 servings

1½ teaspoons salt
½ teaspoon dry mustard
White pepper, as desired
¼ cup sugar
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1 tablespoon tarragon vinegar
¼ cup table cream
3 cups coarsely shredded cabbage
¼ cup finely chopped green pepper
1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
½ cup finely chopped celery
2 tablespoons finely chopped onion

Thoroughly mix all ingredients except vegetables.

Combine vegetables; mix well. Gently stir in the dressing. Chill before serving.

Potato salad

6 servings

½ cup mayonnaise
1 teaspoon dry mustard
2½ teaspoons salt
2 tablespoons finely chopped onion
2 tablespoons chopped green pepper
¾ cup finely chopped celery
¼ cup sweet pickle relish

1 tablespoon chopped pimiento
6 medium-size boiled potatoes, diced
3 hard-cooked eggs, chopped

Combine ingredients except potatoes and eggs; mix thoroughly. Pour this mixture over potatoes and mix gently. Add chopped eggs. Chill several hours before serving.

Variation

Pea salad.—Use 1 package (10 ounces) frozen peas, cooked and drained, or 1 can (1 pound) peas, drained, in place of potatoes. Reduce salt to 1 teaspoon. Add 1 cup process Cheddar cheese cubes.

Basic french dressing

About 1 cup

$\frac{2}{3}$ cup salad oil
1 tablespoon tarragon vinegar
2 tablespoons lemon juice
1½ teaspoons salt
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon paprika
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon dry mustard
White pepper, as desired

Thoroughly mix all ingredients. Chill. Shake well just before serving.

Variations

Sweet french dressing.—Increase vinegar to 2 tablespoons and add $\frac{1}{4}$ cup sugar.

Italian dressing.—Use $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon white pepper. Add $\frac{1}{4}$ cup finely chopped onion, 1 teaspoon finely chopped garlic, 2 tablespoons sugar, $\frac{1}{2}$ cup catsup, and $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon oregano. Refrigerate, covered, overnight to blend flavors. Strain to remove onion and garlic before serving. About 1½ cups.

Roquefort (blue) cheese dressing

About 1 cup

- 1 cup mayonnaise
- 1 package (4 ounces) Roquefort or blue cheese, crumbled
- 2 tablespoons half-and-half or table cream
- ½ teaspoon tabasco sauce

Mix all ingredients.

Refrigerate until used.

Orange-honey french dressing

About 1¼ cups

- ¼ cup orange juice frozen concentrate
- 1 tablespoon vinegar
- ¼ cup honey
- ½ teaspoon dry mustard
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ⅔ cup salad oil

Thoroughly mix all ingredients except salad oil.

Add the oil slowly while beating constantly with rotary or electric beater.

Refrigerate until used.

Celery seed dressing

About 1 cup

- ⅓ cup sugar
- 2 tablespoons lemon juice
- 1 tablespoon tarragon vinegar
- 1½ teaspoons salt
- ½ teaspoon paprika
- ½ teaspoon dry mustard
- 1 teaspoon celery seed
- ⅔ cup salad oil

Thoroughly mix all ingredients except salad oil.

Add the oil slowly while beating constantly with rotary or electric beater.
Refrigerate until used.

Thousand island dressing

About 2 cups

1 cup mayonnaise
¼ cup sweet pickle relish
2 tablespoons chili sauce
1 tablespoon chopped green pepper
1 tablespoon finely chopped onion
1 hard-cooked egg, finely chopped

Mix all ingredients except the egg. Gently mix in the chopped egg.
Refrigerate until used.

Soups

Steaming hot, hearty soups and chowders make delicious dishes for luncheon or supper. When they contain substantial amounts of fish, meat, milk, dry beans or peas, they are filling enough to be the main part of your meal. Or you can serve soup with a salad or a sandwich.

Turkey-vegetable soup

6 servings

1 small onion, chopped
2 tablespoons butter or margarine
2 cups water
2 chicken bouillon cubes
2 cups cooked turkey, diced
½ cup celery tops and pieces
1½ cups diced potatoes
1 cup diced carrots
2½ cups milk
2 tablespoons flour
1 teaspoon salt
⅛ teaspoon pepper

Cook onion in fat until tender. Add water, bouillon cubes, turkey, and vegetables.

Boil gently, covered, until vegetables are tender.

Stir a little of the milk into the flour until mixture is smooth; add remaining milk, salt, and pepper. Add milk mixture to soup.

Simmer, stirring occasionally to prevent sticking, until soup is slightly thickened.

Variation

Chicken-vegetable soup.—Use chicken instead of turkey, and chicken broth instead of water and bouillon cubes.

Menu suggestion

Serve with a cucumber salad, toast, and cherry pie.

Hearty vegetable soup

6 servings

1 cup cooked beef, cut in small pieces

6 cups beef broth

2 cups fresh or canned tomatoes

1 cup diced potatoes

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup diced carrots

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup sliced onion

3 cups other uncooked vegetables (green peas, chopped cabbage, diced celery, cut green beans, chopped green pepper, sliced okra, diced turnips, cut corn)

1½ teaspoons salt

$\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon pepper

Combine beef and broth in a large saucepan. Add remaining ingredients.

Cook, covered, about 35 minutes, or until vegetables are tender.

NOTES: In place of beef broth use 6 beef bouillon cubes and 6 cups water. (Liquid from canned or cooked vegetables may replace some of the water.)

Canned or leftover vegetables may be used instead of uncooked vegetables. Add to soup during last few minutes of cooking.

Menu suggestion

Serve with toasted cheese sandwiches and have fruit gelatin for dessert.

Bean soup

6 servings

1½ cups dry beans

7 cups water

Ham pieces or ham bone

1 small onion, chopped

2 celery stalks, chopped
1 teaspoon salt
¼ teaspoon pepper

Boil beans in the water for 2 minutes; remove from heat. Let soak in cooking water 1 hour, or overnight if preferred.

Add remaining ingredients. Simmer, covered, until beans are soft, about 2 to 3 hours.

Remove ham bone and partially mash beans before serving soup.

Menu suggestion

Serve with coleslaw, cornbread, and apple pie with cheese.

New England fish chowder

6 servings

1 pound fish fillets or steaks, fresh or frozen
2 tablespoons chopped bacon or salt pork
½ cup chopped onion
2½ cups diced potatoes
1½ cups boiling water
1 teaspoon salt
Pepper, as desired
2 cups milk
1 tablespoon butter
Chopped parsley

Thaw frozen fish. Remove skin and bones. Cut fish into 1-inch pieces.

Fry bacon or salt pork in a 3-quart saucepan until crisp. Add onion and cook until tender. Add potatoes, water, salt, pepper, and fish. Cover; simmer 15 to 20 minutes, or until potatoes are tender.

Add milk and butter. Heat. Garnish with parsley.

Menu suggestion

Serve with crackers, fruit salad, and chocolate cake.

Manhattan fish chowder

6 servings

1 pound fish fillets or steaks, fresh or frozen

¼ cup chopped bacon or salt pork

½ cup chopped onion

2 cups boiling water

1 can (1 pound) tomatoes

1 cup diced potatoes

½ cup diced carrots

½ cup chopped celery

¼ cup catsup

1 tablespoon worcestershire sauce

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon pepper

¼ teaspoon thyme

Chopped parsley

Thaw frozen fish. Remove skin and bones. Cut fish into 1-inch pieces.

Fry bacon or salt pork in a 3-quart saucepan until crisp. Add onion and cook until tender. Add water, vegetables, catsup, and seasonings except parsley. Cover and simmer 40 to 45 minutes, or until vegetables are tender.

Add fish. Cover and simmer about 10 minutes longer, or until fish flake easily when tested with a fork. Garnish with parsley.

Menu suggestion

Serve with marinated green bean salad, peaches, and oatmeal cookies.

Croutons

6 servings

3 slices bread

2 tablespoons softened butter or margarine

¼ teaspoon garlic salt

Paprika

Trim crusts from bread. Blend butter or margarine with garlic salt; spread on both sides of bread. Cut bread into cubes; place them on baking sheet and sprinkle with paprika.

Bake at 300° F. (slow oven) until crisp and golden brown, about 20 to 30 minutes.

Serve on soups or salads or as a soup accompaniment.

Variation

Cheese croutons.—Mix bread cubes lightly with ½ cup grated Parmesan cheese before placing on baking sheet.

Creamy potato soup

6 servings

5 cups raw diced potatoes

¼ cup finely chopped onion

1½ cups water

3 cups potato cooking liquid and milk

2 tablespoons butter or margarine

2 teaspoons salt

Pepper, as desired

Paprika or chopped parsley

Cook potatoes and onion in water in a covered saucepan until potatoes are tender, about 15 minutes. Drain and mash potatoes; save cooking liquid.

Measure liquid; add enough milk to make 3 cups.

Slowly stir liquid into potatoes; add fat and seasonings.

Simmer a few minutes to blend flavors. Garnish with paprika or parsley.

Menu suggestion

Serve with tossed vegetable salad, cheese muffins, and fresh fruit.

Cream of broccoli soup

6 servings

1 package (10 ounces) frozen chopped broccoli
1 tablespoon finely chopped onion
¼ cup flour
3 cups vegetable cooking liquid and milk
1 tablespoon butter or margarine
1½ teaspoons salt
Pepper, as desired
1 hard-cooked egg, sliced, if desired

Cook broccoli according to package directions, but omit salt and add onion. Drain; save cooking liquid.

Mix flour with part of milk mixture until smooth. Add remaining liquid to broccoli. Stir in flour mixture, fat, and seasonings.

Cook over moderate heat, stirring occasionally, until soup is slightly thickened and flavors are blended. Garnish with slices of hard-cooked egg, if desired. Serve with croutons (see recipe on this page).

Menu suggestion

Serve with meat sandwiches and baked apples.

Sauces and Gravies

Sauces and gravies are not difficult if you begin with these basic recipes. As you become more expert, you can develop your own variations.

White sauce

1 cup

	<i>Thin</i>	<i>Medium</i>	<i>Thick</i>
Fat (tablespoons)	1	1 or 2	2 or 3
Flour (tablespoons)	1	2	3 or 4
Salt (teaspoon)	$\frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{1}{4}$
Milk (cup)	1	1	1

Melt butter, margarine, or other fat in heavy saucepan. Blend in flour until smooth. Add salt. Add milk slowly, stirring rapidly to prevent lumping. Bring mixture to a boil, stirring constantly. Reduce heat and cook 1 minute, stirring constantly. Remove from heat.

Thin white sauce is used in cream soup, gravy, and in creamed and scalloped vegetables, eggs, fish, and meat.

Medium white sauce is also used in gravy and in creamed and scalloped vegetables, eggs, fish, and meat.

Thick white sauce is used in hollandaise sauce and as a binder for croquettes and souffles.

Variations

Cheese sauce.—Add 1 cup of finely grated cheese to 1 cup hot white sauce, either thin or medium. Stir until cheese is melted, taking care not to overcook.

Egg sauce.—To 1 cup of hot medium white sauce add: 3 chopped, hard-cooked eggs; 1 tablespoon lemon juice; a few drops of yellow food coloring, if desired. Stir.

Onion sauce.—Use proportions for medium white sauce. Brown $\frac{1}{2}$ cup of finely chopped onion in fat before adding flour; then continue as directed above. Add white pepper, as desired.

Gravy

For a thin gravy use 1 tablespoon each of flour and fat or drippings to each cup of liquid; for a medium gravy use 2 tablespoons of flour and 1 or 2 tablespoons of fat or drippings, as desired. If drippings are scant, add a bouillon cube or a little meat extract to the liquid.

METHOD 1.—Use with fat or with drippings containing only fat and browned crusty bits. Measure fat or drippings. Stir flour into fat; brown over low heat. Add liquid slowly, stirring constantly. Cook until thickened, stirring occasionally. Season to taste.

METHOD 2.—Use with fat or drippings containing a considerable amount of liquid. Measure drippings; if necessary add water to make desired amount of liquid. Heat. Combine flour with an equal amount of cold water by stirring or shaking until smooth. Stir slowly into hot liquid. Cook until thickened, stirring occasionally. Season to taste.

Tartar sauce

About $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup mayonnaise or salad dressing
1 tablespoon chopped olives
1 tablespoon chopped onion
1 tablespoon chopped parsley
1 tablespoon chopped sweet pickle

Combine all ingredients and mix well. Chill. Serve with fish.

Honey-orange sauce

About 1 cup

1/3 cup honey
1 tablespoon cornstarch
1 teaspoon grated orange rind
1/2 cup orange juice
1/4 cup water
2 tablespoons butter or margarine

Combine honey, cornstarch, and orange rind in a heavy saucepan. Stir in orange juice and water. Bring to a boil; add fat and blend well. Cool slightly. (Sauce thickens as it cools.)

Can be spooned over warm gingerbread or other desserts.

Sour cream sauce

About 1 cup

1 cup sour cream
1 tablespoon chopped fresh or frozen chives or green onion tops
1/4 teaspoon salt
3 drops worcestershire sauce
White pepper, as desired

Combine all ingredients thoroughly at least 2 hours before serving. Refrigerate. Serve at room temperature or slightly chilled.

Can be served with broccoli or baked potatoes.

Quick vegetable sauce

About 2 cups

1 can (10 1/2 ounces) condensed cream of vegetable, celery, or mushroom soup
1/2 cup half-and-half or table cream

Combine ingredients and heat.

Serve over vegetables, meats, or fish.

Mock hollandaise sauce

About 1 cup

1 cup thick white sauce, made with 3 tablespoons flour and 3 tablespoons fat (p. [57](#))

2 egg yolks, slightly beaten

2 tablespoons lemon juice

Make 1 cup of thick white sauce. Add a little hot white sauce to beaten egg yolks; then stir egg mixture into remaining white sauce. Cook 1 minute over low heat.

Stir in lemon juice. Serve immediately.

Can be served with asparagus, broccoli, or spinach.

NOTE: Use yolks from clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.

Lemon-butter sauce

About 1/3 cup

1/4 cup melted butter or margarine

3/4 teaspoon salt

3/4 teaspoon paprika

1 tablespoon lemon juice

2 teaspoons prepared horseradish

Mix all ingredients well.

Serve hot over vegetables or fish.

Breads and Sandwiches

Hot breads

Bake a batch of homemade bread or yeast rolls, and watch tired appetites perk up. Surprise your family with hot biscuits or muffins.

For a leisurely Sunday breakfast, make waffles or pancakes.

Before using the recipes for breads, see the section on ingredients and measurements (p. [16](#)).

Yeast rolls

18 to 24 rolls

1 package active dry yeast or 1 cake compressed yeast

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup warm water (about 110° F.)

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup hot milk

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup shortening or oil

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup sugar

1 $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoons salt

1 egg

About 4 cups flour

Dissolve yeast in water. Mix milk, fat, sugar, and salt in a large mixing bowl. Cool to lukewarm.

Stir in egg and yeast. Add 2 cups flour and beat until smooth. Gradually stir in more flour until dough leaves sides of bowl.

Turn dough out onto lightly floured surface and knead until dough is smooth and elastic.

Place in a lightly greased bowl and turn over once to grease upper side of dough. Cover and let rise in a warm place (80° to 85° F.) until almost double in bulk, 1 to 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ hours. Dough should rise until a light touch leaves a

slight depression. Press the dough down into the bowl to remove air bubbles.

To make plain rolls, divide dough into small pieces and roll into balls about 1½ inches in diameter. Place in a shallow greased pan with sides touching—or 1 inch apart if you prefer crusty sides.

Cover loosely and let rise in a warm place until double in bulk, 45 minutes to 1 hour.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 15 to 20 minutes.

Brush rolls with melted butter or margarine after removing them from the oven.

Variations

Crescent rolls.—Divide dough into three portions. On a lightly floured surface, roll out each portion into a circle about 10 inches in diameter. Brush with melted butter or margarine. Cut each circle into 6 wedges; roll wedges up tightly, beginning at wide end. Place on greased baking sheet with points down; curve ends to form crescents. Let rise and bake.

Cinnamon-nut rolls.—Roll dough out on lightly floured surface into a rectangle about ¼-inch thick. Brush with melted butter or margarine. Sprinkle with a mixture of ½ cup sugar and 2 teaspoons cinnamon. Press ½ cup chopped nuts into dough. Roll as for jelly roll; seal edge. Cut into ¾-inch slices. Place close together, cut side down, in a greased shallow baking pan. Let rise and bake.

Cloverleaf rolls.—Divide dough into very small pieces and roll into balls about ¾ inch in diameter. Dip each ball in melted butter or margarine and place three balls together in a greased muffin tin. Let rise and bake.

Biscuits

12 biscuits

2 cups flour

1 tablespoon baking powder

1 teaspoon salt

⅓ cup shortening
About ¾ cup milk

Mix dry ingredients thoroughly. Mix in fat only until mixture is crumbly.

Add most of the milk and stir to mix. Add more milk as needed to make a dough that is soft but not too sticky to knead. Knead dough gently on a lightly floured surface 10 to 12 times. Form into a ball.

Pat or roll dough to ½- to ¾-inch thickness. Cut with a floured biscuit cutter or cut into squares with a knife. Place on an ungreased baking sheet—1 inch apart for crusty biscuits; together for softer biscuits.

Bake at 450° F. (very hot oven) 12 to 15 minutes, or until golden brown.

Variations

Cheese biscuits.—Combine ¾ cup shredded sharp or extra sharp cheese with dry ingredients before adding fat.

Sweet biscuits or shortcake.—Combine 1 tablespoon sugar with dry ingredients. Use ¼ cup butter or margarine for fat. Reduce milk to ⅔ cup. Bake at 425° F. (hot oven) 10 to 15 minutes.

Popovers

12 popovers

3 eggs
1 cup milk
2 tablespoons melted fat or oil
1 cup flour
½ teaspoon salt

Grease muffin tins and place them in an oven that is preheating at 450° F. (very hot).

Beat eggs well in a large mixing bowl. Add milk and fat. Mix flour and salt; add to liquid mixture. Beat until smooth.

Fill hot muffin tins half full of batter. Bake at 450° F. 15 minutes; reduce heat to 375° F. (moderate oven) and bake 10 minutes longer. Do not open oven door during baking.

Immediately after baking, insert a paring knife through the top of each popover to allow steam to escape.

Cornbread

6 servings

1 cup yellow cornmeal
1 cup flour
4 teaspoons baking powder
 $\frac{1}{4}$ or $\frac{1}{3}$ cup sugar, as desired
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt
1 cup milk
1 egg, beaten
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup melted shortening or oil

Mix dry ingredients thoroughly. Combine milk and egg; stir in fat. Add liquid to dry ingredients; stir only enough to mix.

Pour batter into a greased 8- by 8- by 2-inch baking pan. Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) about 25 minutes, or until lightly browned.

Variation

Corn muffins.—Fill greased muffin tins half full of batter. Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) about 20 minutes. Makes 12 muffins.

Spoonbread

6 servings

3 cups milk
1 cup cornmeal
 $1\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoons salt
2 tablespoons butter or margarine
4 egg yolks, beaten
4 egg whites

Combine milk, cornmeal, and salt. Cook over low heat, stirring constantly, until thickened, about 15 minutes. Mix in fat. Cool to lukewarm. Stir in egg yolks.

Beat egg whites until stiff, but not dry. Fold into mixture; pour into greased 1½-quart casserole.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) for 35 to 40 minutes or until set. Serve immediately.

Muffins

12 muffins

1 egg
1 cup milk
⅓ cup oil or melted shortening
2 cups flour
1 tablespoon baking powder
1 teaspoon salt
⅓ cup sugar

Beat egg until yolk and white are well blended. Blend in milk and fat.

Mix dry ingredients thoroughly. Add liquid and stir until dry ingredients are barely moistened. Do not overmix. Batter should be lumpy.

Fill greased muffin tins half full of batter. Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 20 to 25 minutes.

Variations

Blueberry muffins.—Increase sugar to ½ cup. Lightly blend in ¾ cup fresh or drained canned blueberries when combining liquid and dry ingredients. Do not crush berries.

Bran muffins.—Reduce flour to 1¼ cups. Mix 2 cups bran flakes or raisin bran cereal with dry ingredients before adding liquid.

Oatmeal-raisin muffins.—Reduce flour to 1¼ cups. Mix 1 cup quick-cooking rolled oats and ½ cup raisins with dry ingredients before adding liquid.

Nut bread

1 loaf

⅔ cup sugar
¼ cup shortening
2 eggs
2 cups flour
3 teaspoons baking powder
½ teaspoon salt
1 cup orange juice or milk
½ teaspoon vanilla
⅔ cup chopped nuts

Beat sugar, shortening, and eggs until creamy.

Mix flour, baking powder, and salt thoroughly. Stir into egg mixture alternately with liquid and vanilla; stir nuts into last portion of flour mixture before blending it into batter.

Pour into greased 9- by 5- by 3-inch loafpan. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 50 to 60 minutes, or until no batter clings to toothpick inserted in center of loaf. Remove from pan and cool on rack.

Quick coffee cake

6 servings

3 tablespoons softened butter or margarine
½ cup granulated sugar
1 egg
1 cup flour
1¼ teaspoons baking powder
¼ teaspoon salt
⅓ cup milk
¼ teaspoon vanilla
⅓ cup brown sugar, packed
½ teaspoon cinnamon
2 tablespoons butter or margarine

Mix 3 tablespoons fat with granulated sugar. Add egg and beat until creamy.

Mix flour, baking powder, and salt thoroughly; add to sugar mixture alternately with milk. Add vanilla. Spread batter evenly in a greased 8-inch square baking pan.

Mix brown sugar and cinnamon and sprinkle over batter. Dot with 2 tablespoons fat. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 25 to 30 minutes.

Pancakes

About 12 pancakes, 4½ inches in diameter

2 cups flour
4 teaspoons baking powder
1 teaspoon salt
2 tablespoons sugar
1 egg, well beaten
1¾ cups milk
⅓ cup oil or melted fat

Heat griddle while mixing batter. When griddle is hot enough, drops of water sprinkled on it will bounce.

Mix dry ingredients thoroughly. Combine egg with milk and fat. Add to dry ingredients and stir only until combined. Batter will be lumpy.

For each pancake, pour about ¼ cup batter onto hot griddle. Cook until edges become slightly dry and bubbles form on top. Turn and brown the other side.

Variation

Waffles.—Increase eggs to 3. Pour batter into hot waffle iron and bake until steaming has almost stopped.

NOTE: For a lighter-textured waffle, beat egg whites separately until stiff but not dry. Fold into waffle batter.

Sandwiches

Sandwiches play many roles in family fare. You can make them fancy for teas and parties—light for snacks—or hearty for the main course at lunch or

supper.

Spread sandwich fillings generously, all the way to the edge of the bread. Fillings should be moist, but not wet. Experiment with new fillings, and with different kinds of bread.

Bacon-cheese sandwiches

6 servings

6 slices bacon

6 slices bread

6 slices (1 ounce each) cheese

Cut bacon slices into halves crosswise; fry until most of fat has cooked out.

Preheat oven with broiler pan and rack in place.

Put a slice of cheese on each bread slice. Top with partly cooked bacon.

Place sandwiches under broiler to lightly brown bacon and melt cheese.

Barbecued beef sandwiches

6 servings

1½ pounds ground beef

1 cup chopped onion

1 cup chopped celery

1 can (8 ounces) spanish-style tomato sauce

¼ cup catsup

2 tablespoons brown sugar, packed

2 tablespoons vinegar

2 tablespoons barbecue sauce

1 tablespoon worcestershire sauce

1 tablespoon prepared mustard

2 teaspoons salt

Pepper, as desired

6 hamburger buns

Crumble beef into saucepan and brown lightly. Drain off excess fat. Mix in onion and celery. Combine tomato sauce, catsup, brown sugar, vinegar, barbecue sauce, and seasonings. Pour over meat, cover pan, and simmer barbecue 1½ to 2 hours, or until flavors are well blended.

Spoon beef mixture over buns.

Fish-cheeseburgers

6 servings

6 frozen fried fish portions or 12 frozen fried fish sticks

6 buttered hamburger buns

6 tablespoons chili sauce

6 slices (1 ounce each) cheese

Place frozen fried fish portions or fish sticks in a single layer on a well-greased baking sheet. Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 15 to 20 minutes, or until heated through.

Place 1 fish portion or 2 fish sticks on bottom half of each bun on a baking sheet. Top each sandwich with 1 tablespoon chili sauce, a slice of cheese, and other half of bun.

Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 8 to 10 minutes, or until cheese melts.

Meat salad sandwiches

6 servings

2 cups ground cooked meat

⅓ cup mayonnaise or salad dressing

⅓ cup pickle relish

½ teaspoon salt (omit when ham is used)

Pepper, as desired

12 slices bread

Softened butter or margarine

Combine meat, salad dressing, relish, and seasonings; mix well. Chill.

Spread bread with butter or margarine. Then spread 6 slices with meat mixture and top each with second slice of bread.

Variations

Grilled open-face sandwiches.—Use 6 slices bread. Toast bread on one side under broiler. Spread untoasted side of the bread with butter or margarine and meat mixture. Broil sandwiches until meat browns slightly. Serve piping hot.

Poultry salad sandwiches.—Use 2 cups of ground cooked poultry as the meat.

Desserts

Dessert adds a touch that gives a good dinner its final, satisfying note.

Before using the dessert recipes in this bulletin, refer to the section on ingredients and measurements (p. [16](#)).

Cake recipes in this publication generally need to be adapted for use in high-altitude areas. Write to your State Experiment Station or contact your county extension agent for information on baking cakes in your area.

For pies and cakes, use pans of the size specified.

To grease pans for cakes, coat lightly with unsalted fat or oil. Then sprinkle lightly with a little flour. Tip pan from side to side to coat evenly; then shake out excess flour.

In recipes that call for greased and floured cakepans, you may use a wax paper lining if you prefer. Cut wax paper to fit the bottom of the pan. Then grease the paper lightly.

Pastry

8- or 9-inch pastry shell

1 cup flour

½ teaspoon salt

⅓ cup shortening

About 2 tablespoons cold water

Mix flour and salt thoroughly. Mix in fat only until mixture is crumbly.

Add a little water at a time, blending lightly. Dough should be just moist enough to cling together when pressed.

Shape dough into a ball. Roll out on a lightly floured surface or between two sheets of waxed paper. Fit carefully into piepan. Lift edges and smooth out air bubbles. For baked pastry shell, trim pastry, leaving about 1 inch around the edge. Fold edge under and shape into an upright rim.

Prick bottom and sides well with a fork. Bake at 450° F. (very hot oven) 12 to 15 minutes, or until golden brown.

Variation

Two-crust pie.—Double the recipe. Form dough into two balls, one slightly larger than the other. Roll out larger ball of dough and fit into piepan. Roll out remaining dough for top crust; make several slits in crust to let steam escape during baking. Put filling into pastry-lined pan. Top with second crust. Fold edges of crusts under and press together to seal. Bake as directed in pie recipe.

Apple pie

8-inch pie, 6 servings

Pastry for 2-crust 8-inch pie (above)

5 cups pared, sliced tart apples

$\frac{2}{3}$ cup sugar

1 tablespoon cornstarch

$\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon cinnamon

1 or 2 tablespoons butter or margarine, if desired

Prepare unbaked pastry.

Mix dry ingredients lightly with apples in a bowl. Put filling into pastry-lined pan. Dot with fat, if desired. Top with second crust.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) for 40 to 60 minutes, or until filling bubbles and the crust is golden brown.

NOTE: If fruit is sweet, decrease amount of sugar; if unusually tart, increase sugar.

Variations

Blueberry pie.—Use 3 cups fresh blueberries instead of apples. Omit cinnamon and increase cornstarch to 3 tablespoons. Sprinkle fruit with 2 tablespoons lemon juice. Bake 50 to 60 minutes.

Cherry pie.—Instead of apples, use 1 can (1 pound) pitted red sour cherries, water pack. Do not drain. Omit cinnamon. Increase cornstarch to 2

tablespoons. Add $\frac{1}{8}$ teaspoon almond extract and a few drops of red food coloring, if desired. Bake 40 to 45 minutes.

Peach pie.—Use 3 cups fresh sliced peaches instead of apples. Use only $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon cinnamon. Bake 40 to 50 minutes.

Vanilla cream pie

8-inch pie, 6 servings

1 8-inch pastry shell (p. [64](#))
3 tablespoons cornstarch
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup sugar
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt
2 cups milk
2 egg yolks, beaten
2 tablespoons butter or margarine
1 teaspoon vanilla
 $\frac{1}{2}$ cup whipping cream
1 tablespoon confectioner's sugar

Prepare, bake, and cool pastry shell.

Mix cornstarch, sugar, and salt in heavy saucepan. Gradually stir in milk.

Cook over moderate heat, stirring constantly, until thickened. Simmer 1 minute longer.

Stir a little of the hot mixture into egg yolks; then stir yolks into remaining hot mixture. Cook 1 minute longer, stirring constantly. Stir in fat and vanilla.

Set saucepan in cold water to cool. Stir frequently. Change water occasionally.

Pour filling into pastry shell. Chill thoroughly.

Before serving, whip cream until stiff and beat in confectioner's sugar. Spread over pie.

NOTES: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Use whipped dessert topping instead of whipped cream, if desired.

Variations

Coconut cream pie.—Stir $\frac{1}{2}$ to 1 cup shredded coconut, as desired, into the hot filling with fat and vanilla.

Banana cream pie.—Slice 2 bananas into pie shell before adding filling.

Chocolate cream pie.—Increase sugar to $\frac{3}{4}$ cup. Cut $1\frac{1}{2}$ ounces bitter chocolate into cream filling after adding milk.

Graham cracker crust

8- or 9-inch pie

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup butter or margarine

2 tablespoons sugar

$1\frac{1}{4}$ cups graham cracker crumbs

Stir fat and sugar together in a saucepan over low heat until fat is melted. Blend in cracker crumbs. Press evenly into piepan. Chill.

Pecan pie

9-inch pie, 8 servings

1 unbaked 9-inch pastry shell (p. [64](#))

1 cup pecan halves

3 eggs, beaten

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup sugar

1 cup dark corn sirup

$\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon salt

1 teaspoon vanilla

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup melted butter or margarine

Prepare unbaked pastry shell. Spread nuts in bottom of pastry shell.

Combine remaining ingredients and pour over nuts. Bake at 375° F. (moderate oven) 30 to 40 minutes, or until the filling appears set when the pie is gently moved.

Pumpkin pie

8-inch pie, 6 servings

1 unbaked 8-inch pastry shell (p. [64](#))
1 cup canned pumpkin
½ teaspoon cinnamon
¼ teaspoon ginger
¼ teaspoon nutmeg
⅛ teaspoon cloves
1 cup milk, half-and-half, or evaporated milk
½ cup sugar
1 egg, slightly beaten
½ teaspoon salt

Prepare unbaked pastry shell.

Blend pumpkin and spices thoroughly. Stir in remaining ingredients; mix well. Pour into pastry shell.

Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) about 1 hour. Pie is done when a table knife inserted in center comes out clean. Filling may be soft but will set on cooling.

Quick meringue-topped pie

8-inch pie, 6 servings

1 baked 8-inch pastry shell (p. [64](#))
1 package (3 to 4 ounces) pudding and pie filling mix, any flavor
2 egg whites
¼ teaspoon salt
¼ cup sugar

Prepare pastry shell.

Make pie filling according to package directions. Cool filling slightly; then pour into baked pastry shell.

Beat egg whites until foamy. Add salt and beat until soft peaks form. Add sugar gradually, beating constantly, and continue beating until stiff peaks form.

Pile meringue on pie while filling is still warm. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 15 to 20 minutes, or until lightly browned.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Lemon chiffon pie

8-inch pie, 6 servings

1 8-inch graham cracker crust (p. [65](#)) or baked pastry shell (p. [64](#))

1 tablespoon unflavored gelatin

¼ cup cold water

3 egg yolks

½ cup lemon juice

½ teaspoon grated lemon rind

¾ cup sugar

3 egg whites

¼ teaspoon salt

Prepare graham cracker crust or pastry shell.

Soften gelatin in cold water. Beat egg yolks slightly. Add juice, rind, and half the sugar. Cook over low heat, stirring constantly, until mixture begins to thicken, 10 to 15 minutes.

Add gelatin; stir until dissolved. Chill until mixture begins to thicken.

Beat egg whites until foamy. Add salt and beat until soft peaks form. Slowly add remaining sugar, beating constantly until stiff. Fold into chilled mixture.

Pour into crust and chill until firm.

NOTE: *Use only clean, sound-shelled eggs in this recipe.*

Variation

Lime chiffon pie.—Use ½ cup lime juice and ½ teaspoon grated lime rind in place of lemon. Add a few drops of green food coloring to dissolved gelatin before chilling.

Fruit delight pie

9-inch pie, 8 servings

- 1 9-inch graham cracker crust (p. [65](#))
- 1 envelope whipped dessert topping mix
- 1 package (8 ounces) cream cheese, at room temperature
- $\frac{1}{4}$ cup confectioner's sugar
- $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon vanilla
- $\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped pecans
- 1 cup canned blueberry, peach, or cherry pie filling

Make graham cracker crust.

Prepare whipped dessert topping according to package directions. Beat in cream cheese, sugar, and vanilla until smooth. Stir in nuts.

Pour into pie shell. Top with pie filling. Chill at least 3 hours before serving.

Spiced prune cake

Two 8- or 9-inch layers

- 1 package spice cake mix (for 2-layer cake)
- $1\frac{1}{4}$ cups drained, pitted, and chopped cooked prunes

Prepare cake batter according to package directions. Thoroughly mix prunes into cake batter. Pour batter into two greased and floured 8- or 9-inch layer cakepans.

Bake according to package directions but increase baking time by 10 minutes. Cool cake a few minutes before removing from the pans. When cool, frost with creamy white frosting (p. [69](#)).

Velvety white cake

Two 8-inch layers

- 2 cups cake flour
- $1\frac{1}{4}$ cups sugar
- 1 tablespoon baking powder
- 1 teaspoon salt

½ cup softened butter or margarine or shortening
1 cup milk
4 egg whites, unbeaten
1 teaspoon vanilla
¼ teaspoon almond extract, if desired

Mix dry ingredients well. Add fat and half of the milk; beat until creamy. Add remaining milk, egg whites, and flavoring; beat until creamy.

Pour into two 8-inch greased and floured layer cakepans. Bake at 375° F. (moderate oven) 25 to 30 minutes, or until the cake surface springs back when touched lightly. Cool cake for a few minutes before removing from the pans. When cool, frost as desired.

Gingerbread

6 to 9 servings

½ cup shortening
½ cup brown sugar, packed
1 egg
½ cup molasses
1½ cups flour
½ teaspoon salt
¾ teaspoon baking soda
½ teaspoon ginger
½ teaspoon cinnamon
½ cup boiling water

Beat shortening and sugar until creamy. Add egg and molasses; beat well.

Mix dry ingredients thoroughly. Add to molasses mixture alternately with boiling water. Beat after each addition.

Pour batter into a greased 8- by 8- by 2-inch baking pan. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 35 to 40 minutes. Serve warm.

Upside-down cake

6 servings

2 tablespoons butter or margarine
½ cup brown sugar, packed
6 drained canned peach halves
6 drained maraschino cherries, halved
12 pecan halves
1 recipe quick coffee cake batter (p. [62](#))

Melt fat in a 9-inch layer cakepan over low heat. Sprinkle brown sugar over fat. Arrange fruit and nuts in sugar mixture.

Prepare coffee cake batter and pour over fruit; spread evenly. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 30 to 40 minutes.

Loosen cake from sides of pan and invert on serving plate. Allow to cool 5 minutes before removing pan.

Variations

Use 12 canned apricot halves or 6 canned pineapple slices or 1 cup of drained canned crushed pineapple for the fruit.

Timesaver

Instead of quick coffee cake batter, use a 1-layer package of cake mix, prepared by package directions.

Cherry cobbler

6 servings

½ recipe sweet biscuit dough (p. [60](#))
⅔ cup sugar
2 tablespoons cornstarch
1 can (1 pound) pitted red sour cherries, water pack
⅛ teaspoon almond extract
Few drops red food coloring
1 tablespoon butter or margarine

Make biscuit dough but do not roll out.

Blend sugar and cornstarch in a 1-quart saucepan. Gradually stir in cherries. Cook over moderate heat until thickened and clear, stirring

constantly. Remove from heat. Add flavoring, food coloring, and fat. Pour into a 1½-quart casserole.

Drop biscuit dough by spoonfuls onto hot cherry mixture. Bake at 425° F. (hot oven) 15 to 20 minutes, or until filling bubbles and topping is lightly browned.

Timesaver

Quick cherry cobbler.—Use 1 can (1 pound 5 ounces) cherry pie filling. Heat to boiling and stir in 1 tablespoon butter or margarine. For biscuit topping, combine 1 cup packaged biscuit mix and 1 tablespoon sugar. Add ⅓ cup milk and 1 tablespoon melted butter or margarine; stir until moistened. Drop by spoonfuls onto hot cherry filling and bake as directed.

Chocolate cake

Two 8-inch layers

1¾ cups cake flour

1⅓ cups sugar

1 teaspoon salt

1 teaspoon baking soda

½ cup softened butter or margarine

1 cup milk

1 teaspoon vanilla

2 eggs

2 or 3 ounces (2 or 3 squares) unsweetened chocolate, melted

Mix dry ingredients well. Add fat and half of the milk; beat until creamy. Mix in remaining milk, vanilla, and eggs. Add chocolate; beat until creamy.

Pour into two 8-inch greased and floured layer cake pans. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 30 to 35 minutes, or until the cake surface springs back when touched lightly. Cool cake a few minutes before removing from the pans. When cool, frost with creamy chocolate frosting (this page).

NOTE: For a loaf cake, use a greased and floured 9- by 12-inch cakepan. Bake about 40 minutes.

Creamy white frosting

For 8-inch layer cake or 9- by 12-inch loaf cake

About 2½ cups confectioner's sugar

⅓ cup softened butter or margarine

3 tablespoons milk

1 teaspoon vanilla

Beat about 2 cups of the sugar with all other ingredients until frosting is creamy and smooth. Beat in enough of the remaining sugar for a frosting that will spread evenly. Spread on cooled cake.

Variation

Creamy chocolate frosting.—Mix in 1 or 2 ounces (1 or 2 squares) of melted chocolate. Or increase milk to ¼ cup and use ⅓ cup cocoa. Beat until creamy and smooth.

Caramel-nut frosting

For 8-inch layer cake or 9- by 12-inch loaf cake

½ cup butter or margarine

1 cup brown sugar, packed

¼ cup milk

2 cups confectioner's sugar

⅔ cup finely chopped pecans or walnuts

½ teaspoon vanilla

Nut halves, as desired

Combine, fat, brown sugar, and milk. Cook over medium heat, stirring constantly, only until mixture boils and sugar is dissolved. Cool slightly.

Beat confectioner's sugar into cooked mixture until frosting reaches spreading consistency. Add chopped nuts and vanilla; mix well.

Spread on cooled cake. Garnish with nut halves.

Orange bavarian cream

6 servings

1 tablespoon unflavored gelatin
¼ cup cold water
¾ cup orange juice
2 tablespoons lemon juice
½ teaspoon grated orange rind
⅓ cup sugar
¼ teaspoon salt
1 cup whipping cream
1 cup fresh orange sections, cut in pieces

Soften gelatin in water. Combine fruit juices, orange rind, sugar, and salt; heat to simmering. Dissolve gelatin in hot mixture. Chill until mixture begins to thicken.

Whip cream only until stiff. Fold whipped cream and orange sections into gelatin mixture. Pour into a 1-quart mold and chill until firm.

Oatmeal cookies

3 to 4 dozen cookies

1 cup flour
1¼ teaspoons baking powder
½ teaspoon baking soda
½ teaspoon salt
½ cup shortening
1 cup brown sugar, packed
1 egg
¾ teaspoon vanilla
1½ cups quick-cooking rolled oats

Mix flour, baking powder, soda, and salt. Beat shortening and sugar until creamy. Beat in egg and vanilla. Blend in flour mixture. Stir in rolled oats. Chill.

Shape dough into balls about 1 inch in diameter. Place about 2 inches apart on an ungreased baking sheet. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 10 to 15 minutes.

Remove from baking sheet while warm.

Variations

Raisin-oatmeal cookies.—Add ½ cup raisins with the oats.

Coconut- or nut-oatmeal cookies.—Add ½ cup flaked coconut or ½ cup chopped nuts with the oats.

Orange-oatmeal cookies.—Add 2 tablespoons orange juice and 1 teaspoon grated orange rind to shortening and sugar mixture. Add ½ cup raisins and ½ cup chopped nuts with the oats. Chill dough thoroughly; drop from teaspoon onto baking sheet.

Peanut butter cookies

4 to 5 dozen cookies

1 cup shortening
1 cup peanut butter
1 cup granulated sugar
1 cup brown sugar, packed
2 eggs
1 teaspoon vanilla
2½ cups flour
½ teaspoon salt
¾ teaspoon baking soda
½ teaspoon baking powder

Beat shortening and peanut butter until creamy. Gradually add sugars, beating thoroughly after each addition. Beat in eggs and vanilla.

Mix remaining ingredients and blend into peanut butter mixture. Shape dough into balls about 1 inch in diameter. Place about 2 inches apart on an ungreased baking sheet. Flatten each cookie. Criss-cross top of each cookie with a fork, if desired.

Bake at 375° F. (moderate oven) 10 to 15 minutes.

Remove from baking sheet while warm.

Variation

Top-hat cookies.—Roll balls of dough in granulated sugar before placing on baking sheet. Do not flatten. Bake 10 minutes; then remove from oven

and press a milk chocolate candy kiss into center of each cookie. Return to oven and bake 2 to 5 minutes longer, or until cookies are done.

Molasses snaps

3 to 4 dozen cookies

¾ cup shortening
1 cup brown sugar, packed
2 eggs
¼ cup molasses
2¼ cups flour
2 teaspoons baking soda
½ teaspoon salt
½ teaspoon cloves
1 teaspoon cinnamon
1 teaspoon ginger
½ cup chopped nuts, if desired
½ cup raisins, if desired

Beat shortening and sugar until creamy. Beat in eggs and molasses.

Mix dry ingredients and stir in raisins and nuts, if used. Stir flour mixture into molasses mixture.

Drop dough from a teaspoon onto a lightly greased baking sheet; space cookies about 2 inches apart. Bake at 375° F. (moderate oven) 10 to 12 minutes, or until set but not hard.

Remove from baking sheet while warm.

Chocolate sparkles

5 to 6 dozen cookies

1 cup softened butter or margarine
1¼ cups sugar
2 eggs
2 ounces (2 squares) unsweetened chocolate, melted
½ teaspoon vanilla

2⅔ cups flour
2 teaspoons cream of tartar
1 teaspoon baking soda
½ teaspoon salt
¼ cup sugar

Beat fat and 1¼ cups sugar until creamy. Beat in eggs; add melted chocolate and vanilla.

Mix flour, cream of tartar, soda, and salt. Stir into chocolate mixture; blend well. Chill dough.

Shape dough into balls about 1 inch in diameter. Roll balls in ¼ cup sugar and place about 2 inches apart on an ungreased baking sheet. Bake at 400° F. (hot oven) 8 to 10 minutes.

Remove from baking sheet while warm.

Variations

Cinnamon-sugar cookies.—Omit chocolate. Roll balls of dough in a mixture of ¼ cup sugar and 1 tablespoon cinnamon; bake as directed.

Chocolate chip cookies.—In place of 1½ cups granulated sugar, use ½ cup granulated sugar and 1 cup brown sugar. Beat sugars with butter or margarine. Omit the chocolate. Stir ⅔ cup chopped nuts and 1 package (12 ounces) chocolate chips into the dough. Drop dough from a teaspoon onto an ungreased baking sheet and bake as directed.

Apple crisp

6 servings

2 tablespoons granulated sugar
¼ teaspoon cinnamon
4 cups pared, sliced tart apples
¼ cup water
½ cup flour
⅛ teaspoon salt
¼ teaspoon cinnamon
¼ teaspoon nutmeg

⅓ cup brown sugar, packed
3 tablespoons softened butter or margarine

Mix granulated sugar with ¼ teaspoon cinnamon; sprinkle over apples and mix lightly. Spread apples in a greased 8- by 8- by 2-inch baking pan. Sprinkle with the water.

Blend flour, salt, cinnamon, nutmeg, and brown sugar. Mix in fat to make a crumbly mixture. Spread over apples. Bake uncovered at 350° F. (moderate oven) 40 minutes or until lightly browned and apples are tender.

Baked apples

6 servings

6 large baking apples
6 tablespoons sugar
2 tablespoons butter or margarine
Cinnamon, as desired
½ cup water

Wash and core apples. Pare apples one-third of the way down or slit the skin around the apple about half-way down.

Place apples in a baking dish. Put sugar and butter or margarine in the center of each apple. Sprinkle with cinnamon. Pour the water around apples to prevent sticking.

Bake uncovered at 400° F. (hot oven) until tender, 45 minutes to 1 hour.

Variation

Cranberry-baked apples.—Omit the sugar, fat, and cinnamon. Combine ¾ cup chopped raw cranberries, ½ cup sugar, and 3 tablespoons chopped nuts. Stuff apples with this mixture before baking.

Brownies

16 brownies

2 ounces (2 squares) unsweetened chocolate
⅓ cup shortening or oil

1 cup sugar
2 eggs, slightly beaten
1 teaspoon vanilla
 $\frac{2}{3}$ cup flour
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon baking powder
 $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt
 $\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped nuts

Melt chocolate and fat together over low heat. Cool slightly. Mix sugar with eggs.

Stir chocolate mixture into eggs gradually. Add vanilla.

Mix dry ingredients, stir in nuts, and add to chocolate mixture.

Spread batter in a greased 8-inch square baking pan. Bake at 350° F. (moderate oven) 25 to 30 minutes or until crust is shiny and brownies begin to shrink from pan. Cool in pan. Cut into 2-inch squares.

Variation

Chewy brownies.—Follow directions above, but omit baking powder.

Baked custard

6 servings

4 eggs, slightly beaten
 $\frac{1}{3}$ cup sugar
 $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon salt
3 cups hot milk
1 teaspoon vanilla
Nutmeg, as desired

Combine eggs, sugar, and salt. Stir in the milk gradually. Add vanilla.

Pour into custard cups. Sprinkle with nutmeg. Set cups in a pan of hot water.

Bake at 325° F. (slow oven) 30 to 40 minutes, or until the tip of a knife inserted in the center comes out clean.

Raisin-nut bread pudding

6 servings

2 cups milk
1 tablespoon butter or margarine
¼ cup brown sugar, packed
1 teaspoon cinnamon
½ teaspoon nutmeg
½ teaspoon vanilla
2 egg yolks, slightly beaten
4 slices bread, cut in 1-inch cubes
½ cup raisins
½ cup slivered almonds
2 egg whites
¼ teaspoon salt

Heat milk. Stir in fat, sugar, cinnamon, nutmeg, and vanilla.

Stir a little of the milk mixture into egg yolks; then stir yolks into rest of milk mixture. Add bread cubes, raisins, and half the nuts.

Beat egg whites until foamy. Add salt and beat until stiff but not dry. Fold egg whites into pudding mixture. Pour into greased 1-quart casserole. Sprinkle top with rest of nuts. Place casserole in pan of hot water.

Bake at 325° F. (slow oven) 1¼ to 1½ hours, or until the tip of a knife inserted in the center comes out clean.

Quick ice cream desserts

Pecan balls.—Toast pecans by spreading 1½ cups in a shallow pan, and baking at 300° F. (slow oven) 15 to 20 minutes, or until lightly browned. Cool and chop. Shape 1 quart ice cream into 6 balls. Roll balls in pecans. Place on a tray covered with wax paper and return to freezer until firm. Just before serving, top balls with hot fudge sauce. Makes 6 servings.

Snowballs.—Shape 1 quart ice cream into 6 balls. Roll balls in ½ cup flaked coconut. Return balls to freezer as directed above. Makes 6 servings.

Ice cream sandwiches.—Slice 1 quart ice cream into 6 slices. Place each slice between 2 graham crackers (plain, cinnamon-flavored, or chocolate-coated). Serve immediately or return to freezer until time to serve. Makes 6 sandwiches.

Buttered nut sundaes.—Add $\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped pecans or walnuts to 2 tablespoons melted butter or margarine in a frypan. Toast nuts over low heat for 15 to 20 minutes, stirring as needed, until they are lightly browned. Stir in $\frac{1}{4}$ cup brown sugar (packed) and $\frac{1}{4}$ cup water; simmer 2 minutes. Pour warm sauce over ice cream. Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup or enough for 6 sundaes.

Ways to Use Leftovers

Don't throw good leftover food away. Use your cooking skill—and your imagination—to make leftovers tasty.

Some leftovers make good second meals merely by reheating. Others are better prepared in a new way—with seasonings, sauces, crisp toppings. Try leftover fruit in muffins, vegetables in omelets. Substitute 2 leftover egg yolks for 1 whole egg in baked custard. And soups often become richer, more delicious when leftovers are added.

Listed below are some of the ways in which leftovers may be used.

Egg yolks, in—

- Baked custard
- Cakes, cookies
- Homemade noodles
- Mock hollandaise sauce
- Scrambled eggs

Egg whites, in—

- Cakes
- Meringue
- Souffles

Hard-cooked egg or yolk, in—

- Casseroles
- Egg sauce
- Garnish
- Salads
- Sandwiches
- Thousand island dressing

Buttermilk, in—

- Cakes, cookies
- Quick breads

Sour cream, in—

- Beef stroganoff
- Cakes, cookies
- Salad dressings
- Sauce for vegetables

Cooked meats, poultry, fish, in—

- Casseroles
- Creamed foods
- Curries
- Hash
- Patties
- Potpies
- Salads
- Sandwiches

Meat or poultry drippings and broth, in—

- Gravies
- Sauces
- Soups
- Stews

Cooked potatoes, in—

- Fried or creamed potatoes
- Meat or potato patties
- Meat-pie topping
- Potatoes in cheese sauce
- Salads
- Soups, stews, or chowders

Cooked snap beans, lima beans, corn, peas, carrots, in—

- Casseroles
- Creamed dishes
- Meat, poultry, or fish pies
- Salads
- Sauces
- Scalloped vegetables

Soups
Stews
Vegetables in cheese sauce

Cooked leafy vegetables, chopped, in—

Creamed or scalloped vegetables
Omelets
Souffles
Soups

Vegetable cooking liquids, in—

Gravies
Sauces
Soups
Stews

Cooked or canned fruits, in—

Fruit cups
Fruit sauces
Gelatin desserts
Prune cake
Quick breads
Salads
Shortcake
Upside-down cake
Yeast breads

Fruit cooking liquids or fruit sirups, in—

Fruit cups
Fruit sauces
Fruit drinks
Gelatin mixtures
Tapioca puddings

Cooked wheat, oat, or corn cereals, in—

Fried cereal
Meat loaf or patties

Souffles
Sweet puddings

Cooked rice, noodles, macaroni, spaghetti, in—

Baked macaroni and cheese
Casseroles
Macaroni salad
Meat or cheese loaf
Spanish rice

Bread, in—

Bread pudding
Croutons
Dry crumbs for breading meat, poultry, or fish
Fondues
French toast
Meat loaf, salmon loaf
Sardine puff
Stuffings

Cookies or unfrosted cake, in—

Crumb crust for pies
Ice cream sandwiches
Refrigerator cake (cake strips or cookies layered with pudding or whipped cream and chilled)
Toasted cake slices, served with fruit or ice cream

Cooking Terms

Bake	To cook in an oven or oven-type appliance in a covered or uncovered container.
Barbecue	To roast slowly on a spit or rack, usually basting with a highly seasoned sauce. Also, foods cooked in or served with barbecue sauce.
Baste	To pour melted fat, drippings, or other liquid over food to moisten it during cooking.
Boil	To cook in water or other liquid at boiling temperature (212° F. at sea level). Bubbles rise continually and break on the surface.
Braise	To cook meat or poultry slowly in steam from meat juices or added liquid trapped and held in a covered pan. Meat may be browned in a small amount of fat before braising.
Broil	To cook uncovered on a rack placed directly under heat or over an open fire. <i>Pan broil.</i>—To cook in uncovered pan over direct heat, pouring fat off as it accumulates.
Caramelize	To heat sugar or food containing sugar until a brown color and characteristic flavor develop.
Fold	To combine two mixtures (or two ingredients such as beaten egg white and sugar) by gently cutting down through mixture, turning over, and repeating until well mixed.
Fry	To cook in fat without water, uncovered. <i>Pan-fry or saute.</i>—To cook in frypan in a small amount of fat. <i>Deep-fry or french-fry.</i>—To cook in a deep kettle, in enough fat to cover or float food.
Grill	Same as broil.
Knead	To press, stretch, and fold dough or other mixture to make it elastic or smooth. Bread dough becomes elastic; fondant

	becomes smooth and satiny.
Marinate	To let foods stand in a liquid (usually mixture of oil with vinegar or lemon juice) to add flavor or to make more tender.
Parboil	To boil until partly cooked.
Poach	To simmer gently in liquid so food retains its shape.
Pot-roast	To cook large cuts of meat by braising.
Reconstitute	To restore concentrated food—such as frozen orange juice or dry milk—to its original state, usually by adding water.
Rehydrate	To soak or cook dried foods to restore the water lost in drying.
Roast	To cook in heated air—usually in an oven—without water, uncovered.
Simmer	To cook in liquid just below the boiling point, at temperatures of 185° to 210° F. Bubbles form slowly and break below the surface.
Steam	To cook food in steam, with or without pressure. Food is steamed in a covered container on a rack or in a perforated pan over boiling water.
Stew	To cook in liquid, just below the boiling point.

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OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Additional information helpful in preparing meals for your family is given in these publications, available from the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, D.C. 20250. Send your request on a post card and include your ZIP code.

Beef and Veal in Family Meals: A Guide for Consumers	G 118
Cheese in Family Meals: A Guide for Consumers	G 112
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Poultry in Family Meals: A Guide for Consumers	G 110
Storing Perishable Foods in the Home	G 78
Vegetables in Family Meals: A Guide for Consumers	G 105

FAMILY FARE is a result of USDA research. Here, the Agricultural Research Service brings together information on nutrition, food management, and food preparation.

Guidelines for nutritious meal planning and for food management came from the Consumer and Food Economics Research Division of ARS. Basic cooking methods and recipes were developed and taste-tested in the ARS Food Quality and Use Laboratory of the Human Nutrition Research

Division. Fish recipes and information on buying fish were contributed by home economists in the Bureau of Commercial Fisheries, Department of the Interior.

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